

FALL 2024

Research
March 2025

NJ TRANSIT



Customer Satisfaction Survey Background

- Covers all modes – Bus, Rail, Light Rail & Access Link
- Conducted in Spring and Fall
- Methodology has remained consistent to track scores over time
  - Customers rate their satisfaction with service traits on a scale of 0 to 10
  - Customers identify the most important service traits
- Survey is administered online with an extensive campaign to increase participation and boost response rates in target markets

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2024 Survey Background

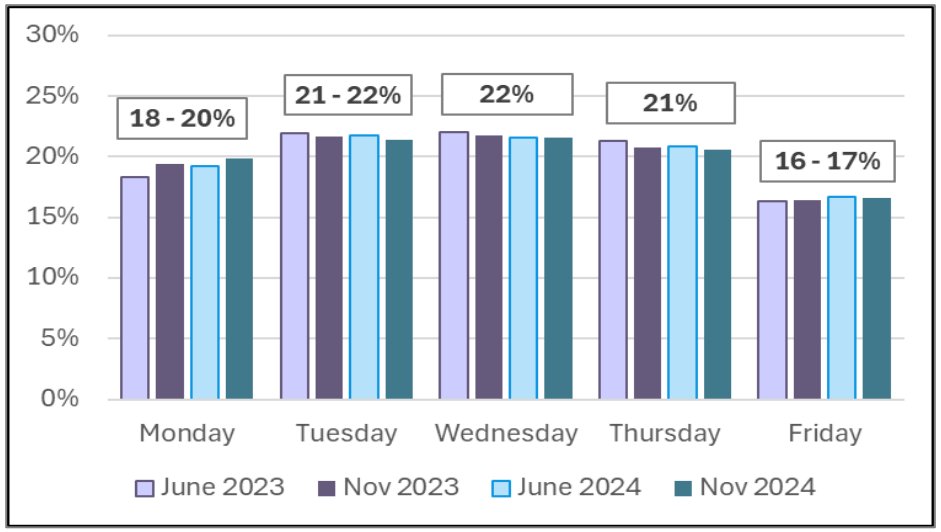
- Conducted from October 30th through November 30th
- Received nearly 36,000 surveys from customers
- Survey included standard Customer Satisfaction questions and COVID-related questions
- To encourage more participation -- offered 250 NJT Rewards Points to all customers that completed the survey and were a member or signed up for NJT Rewards

TRANSIT

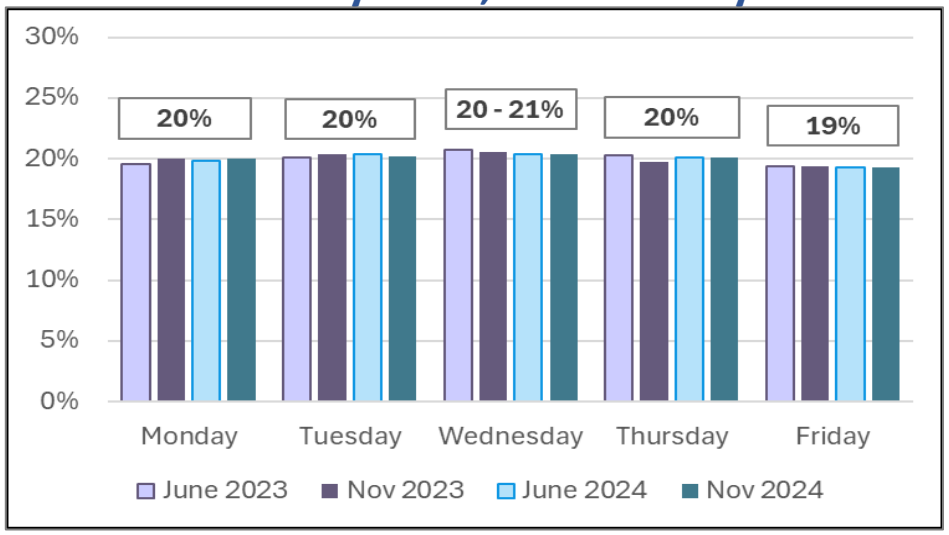
COVID-Related Findings
Distribution of Weekday Work Trips on NJ TRANSIT by Day of the Week

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

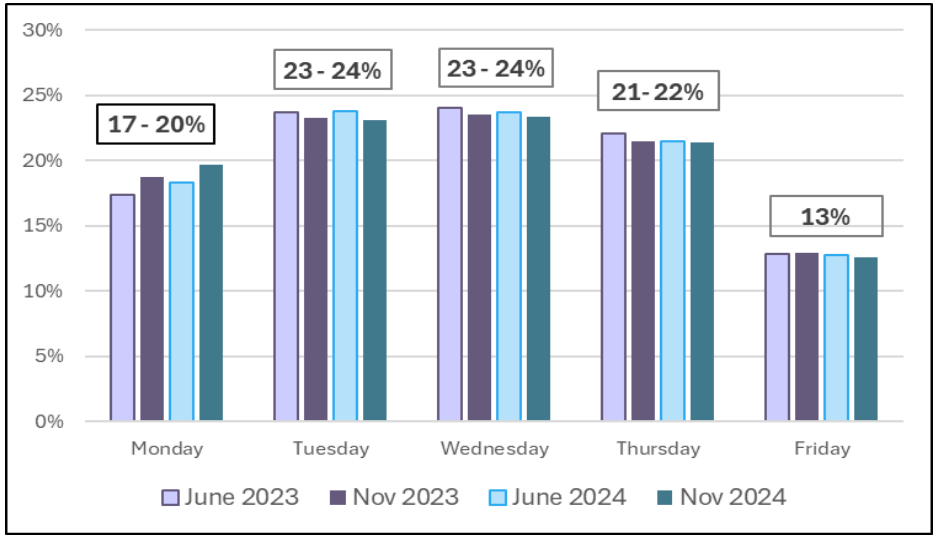
Bus – NY Interstate



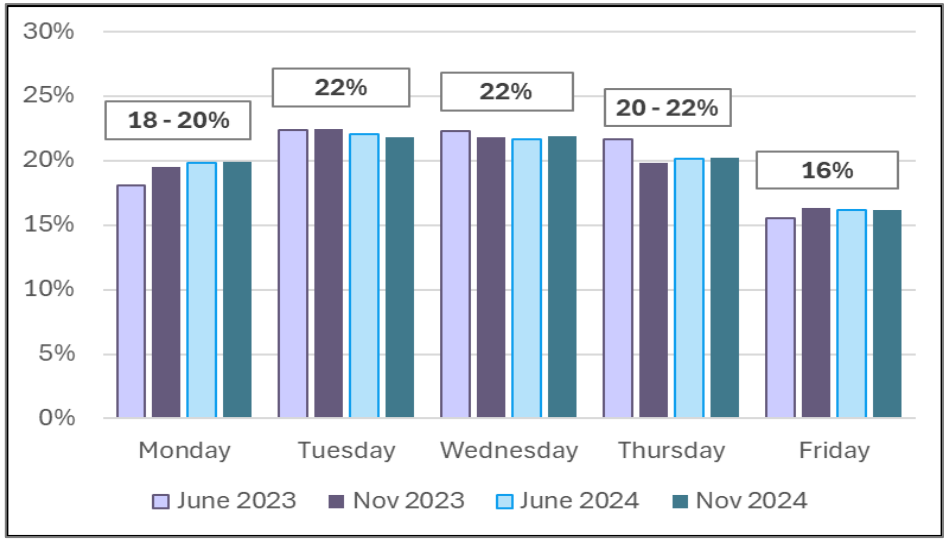
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



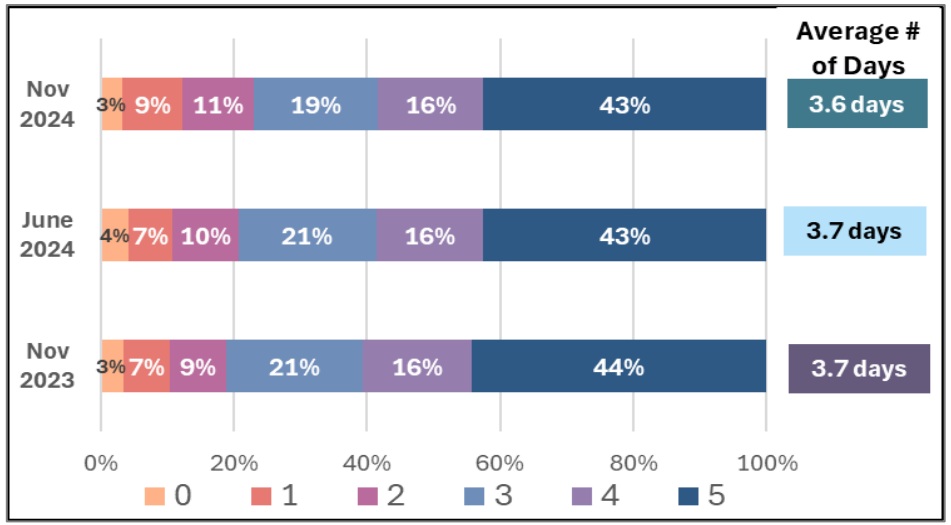
- The days of the week that customers typically ride NJ TRANSIT travel to their office/worksite has remained consistent for the last 4 surveys over the last two years.

TRANSIT

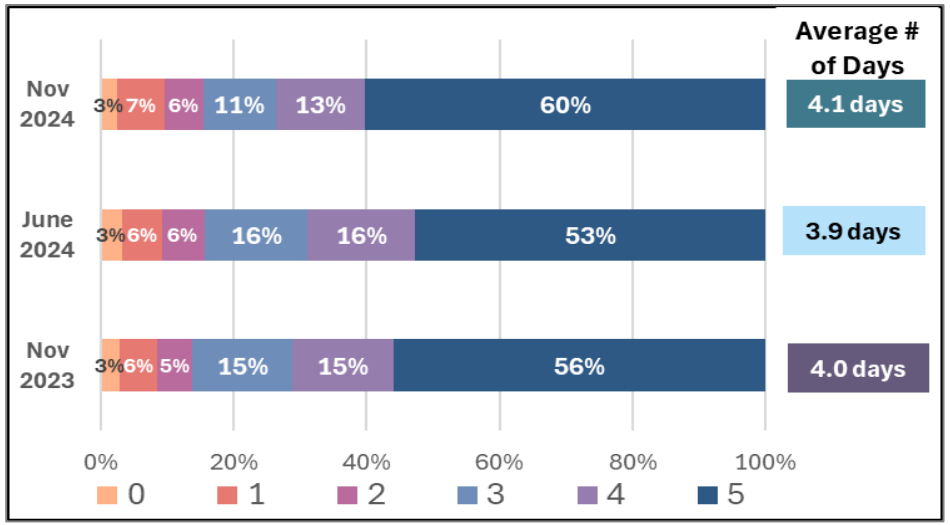
COVID-Related Findings
In the last 7 days, how many weekdays did you travel to your office/worksite?

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

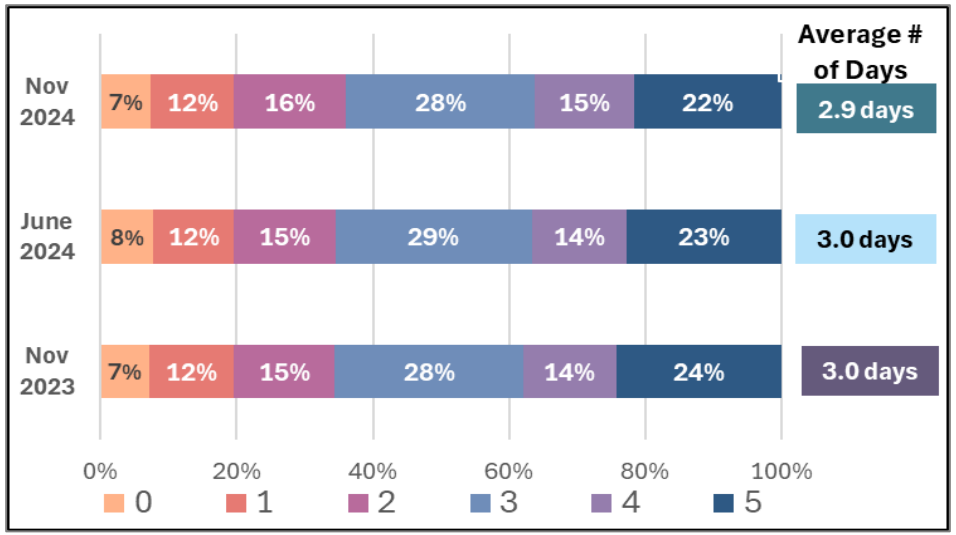
Bus – NY Interstate



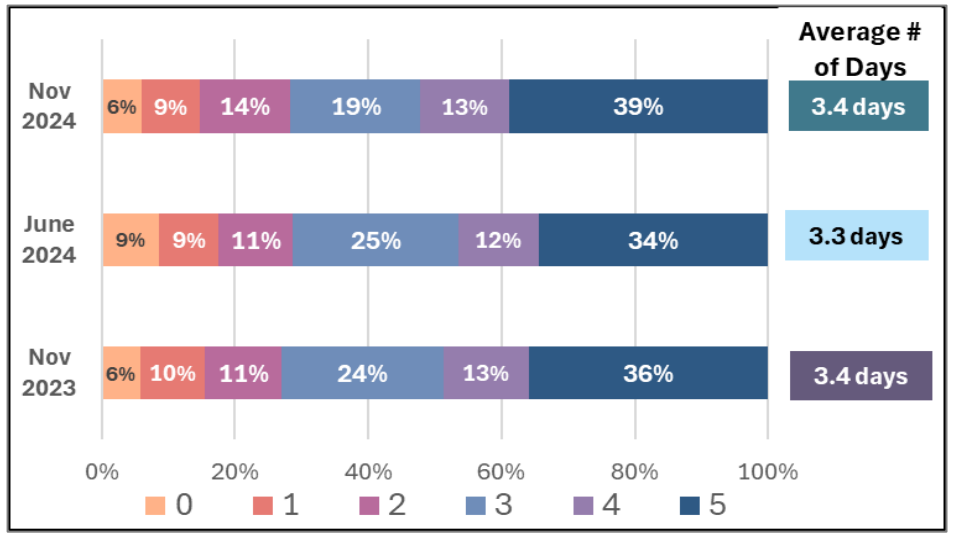
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



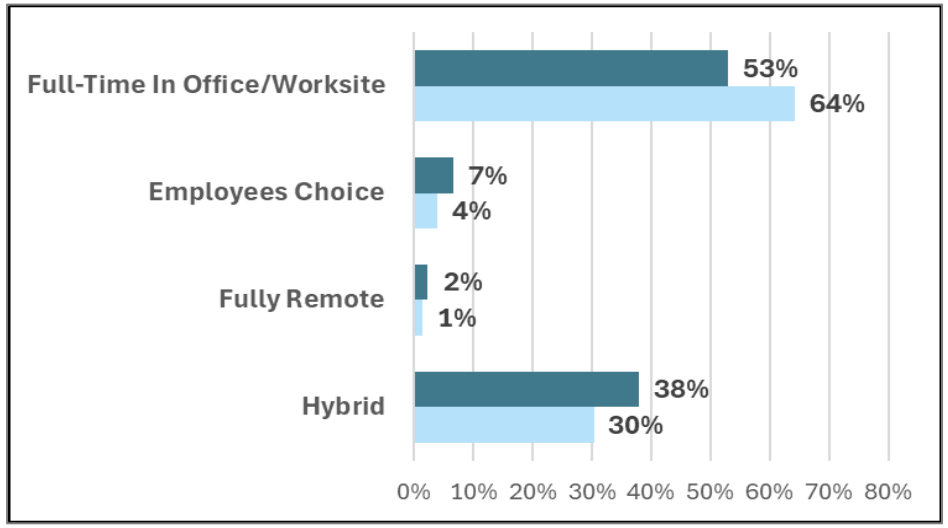
- Weekday commuting remains steady
- More Local Bus and Light Rail customers report traveling 5 days/week

TRANSIT

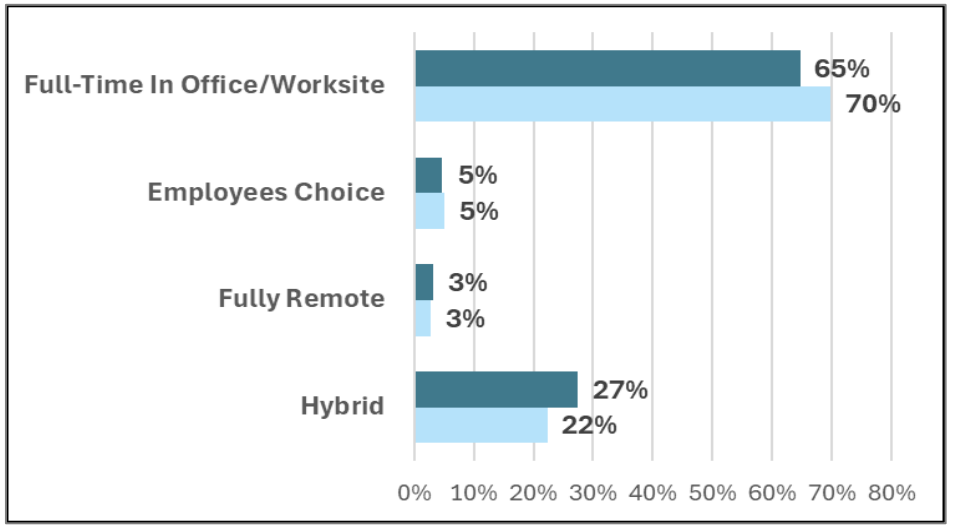
COVID-Related Findings
Your Company's Current Office/Worksite Attendance Policy

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

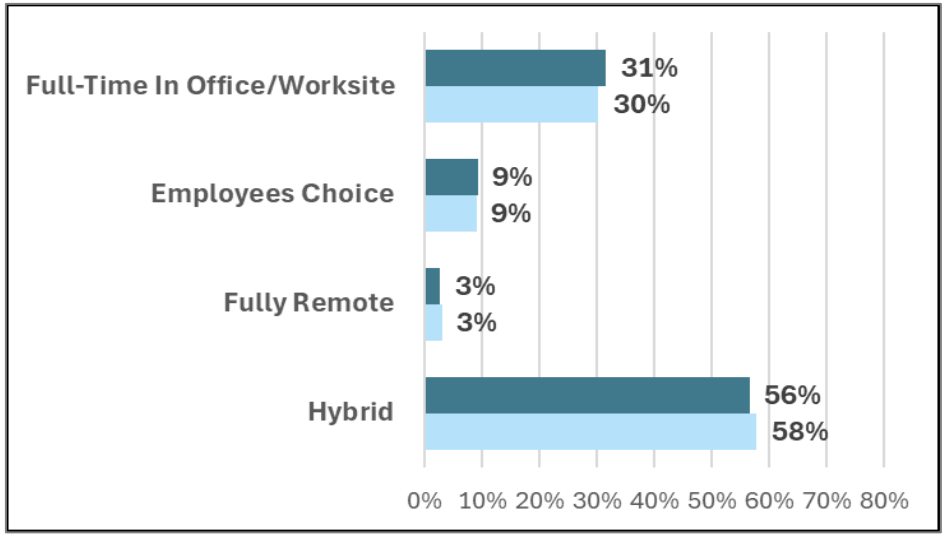
Bus – NY Interstate



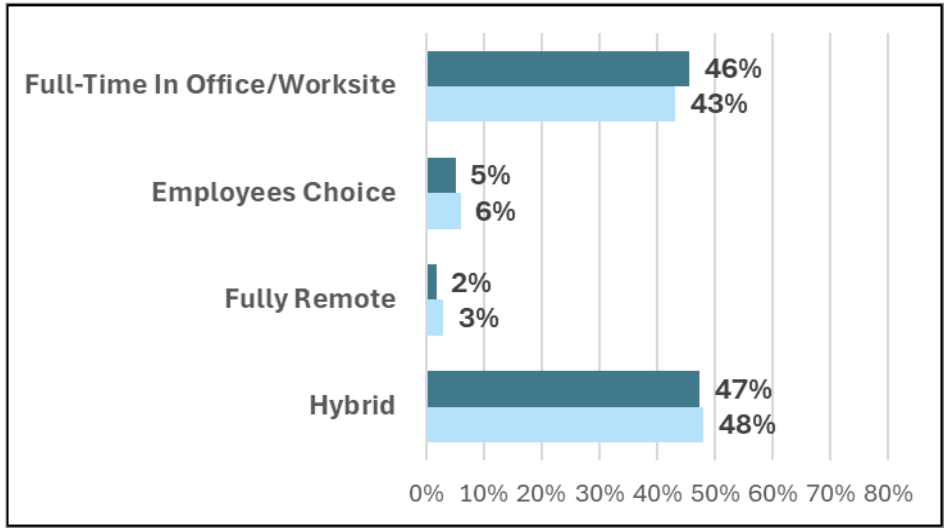
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



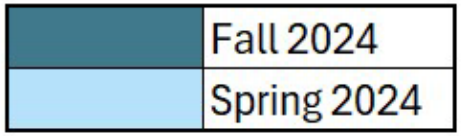
Rail



Light Rail



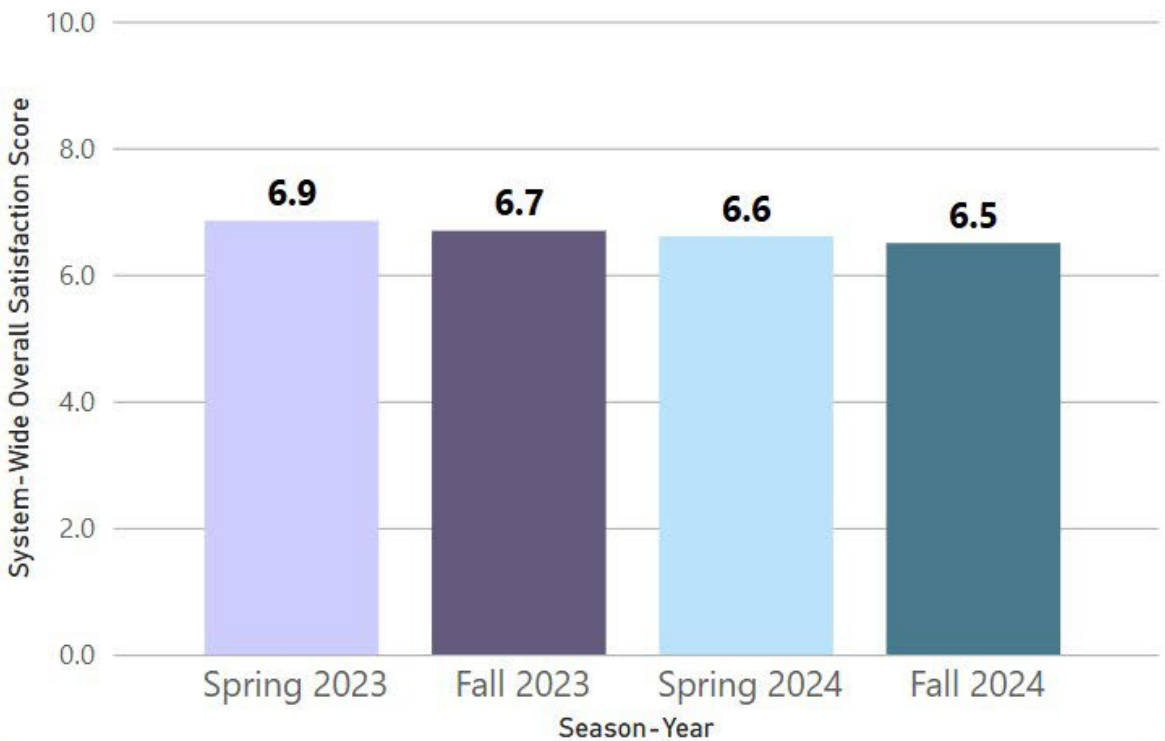
- Full time in office has decreased for NY Bus and Local Bus since the Spring survey
- Hybrid is highest for Rail
- Minimum Days of the Week is the most common hybrid work policy



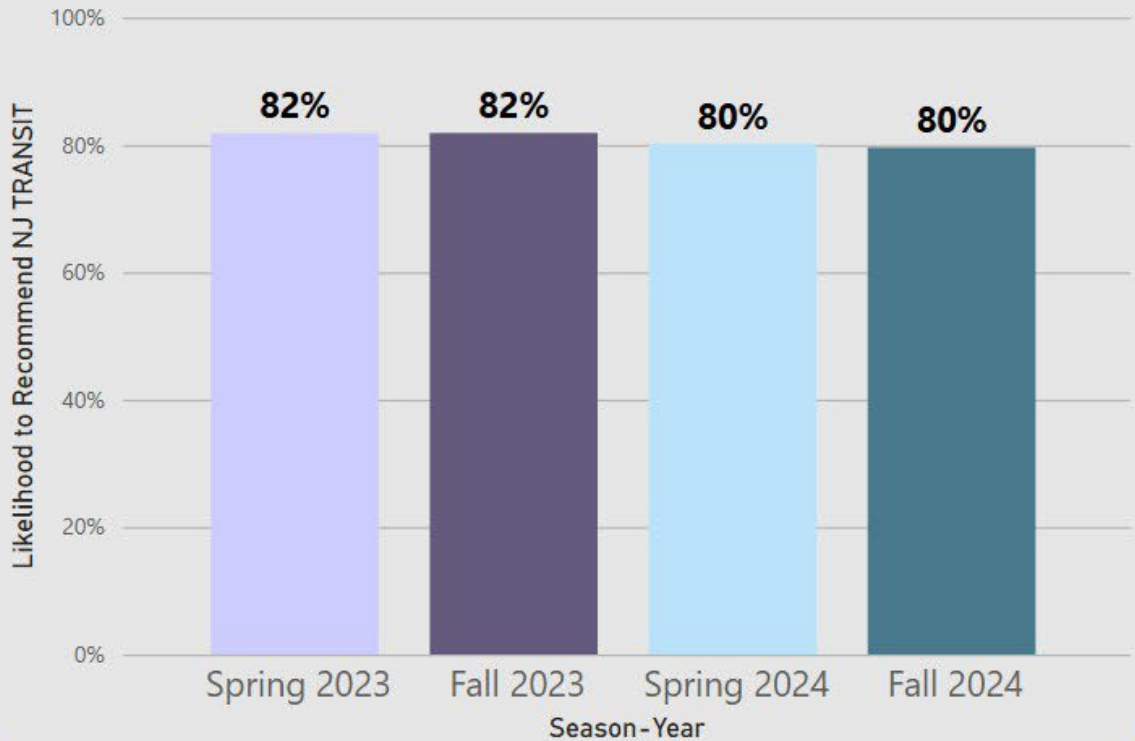
TRANSIT

System-Wide Results

Overall Satisfaction Score



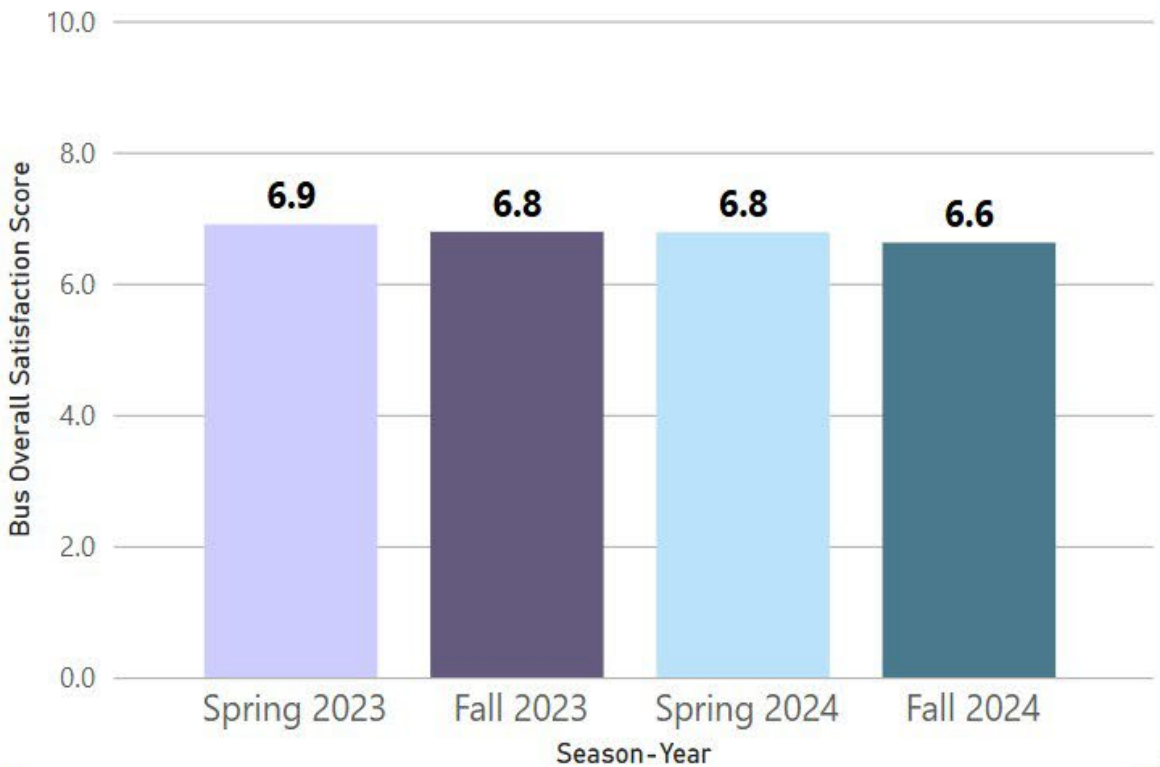
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



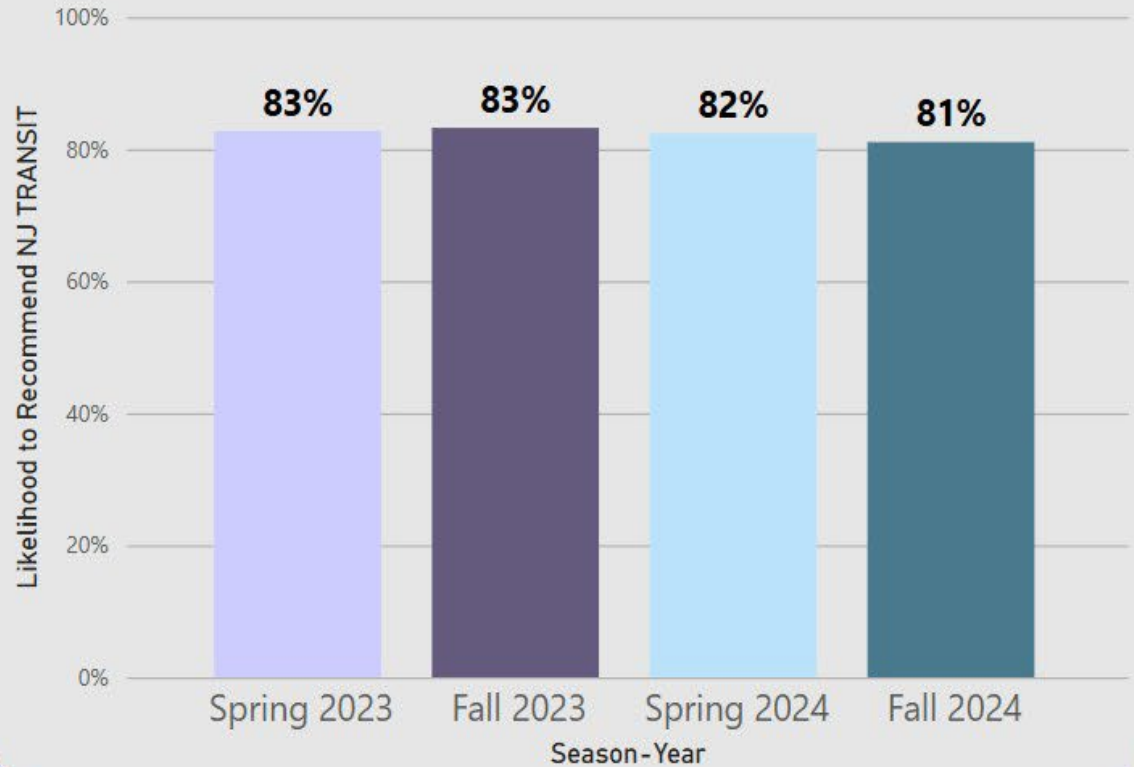
TRANSIT

Bus System

Overall Satisfaction Score



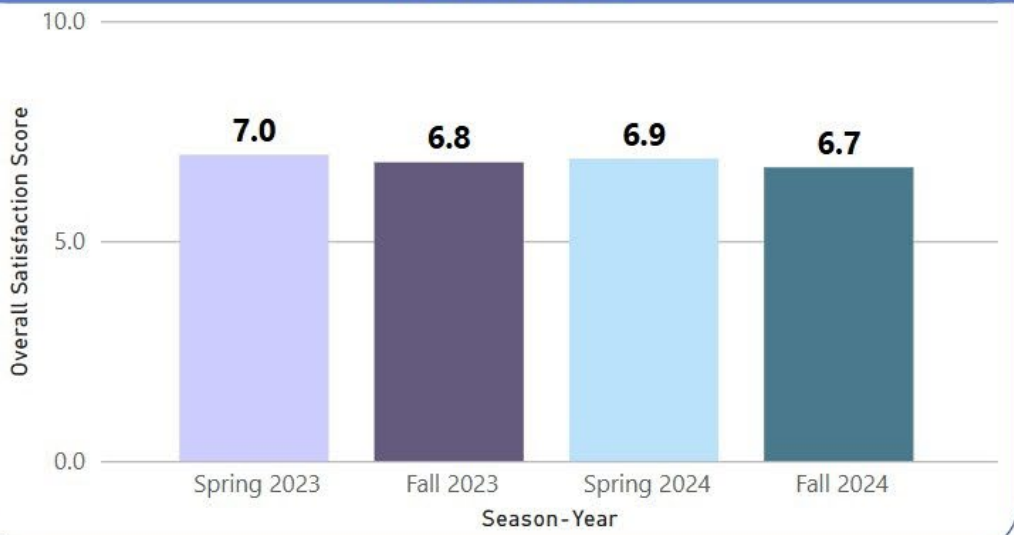
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



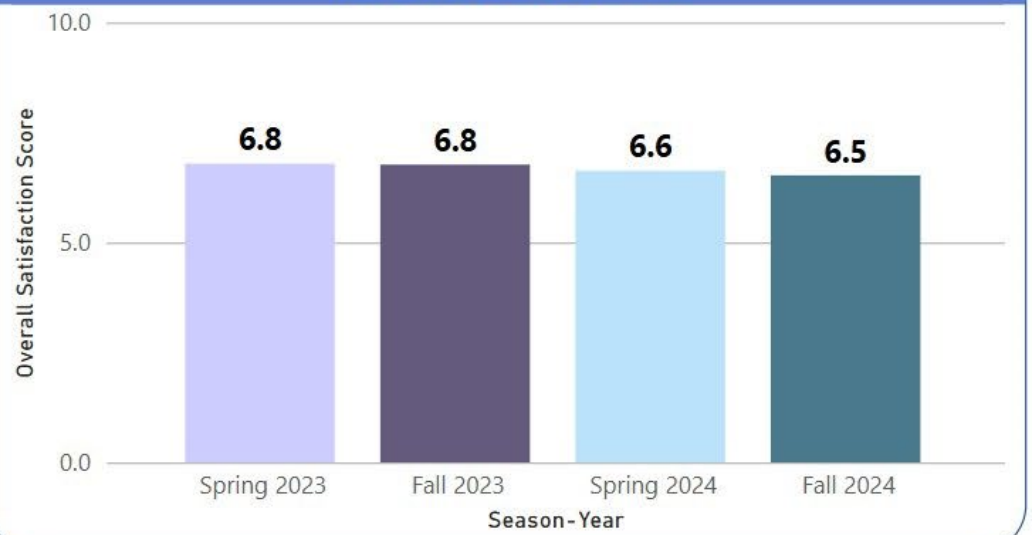
TRANSIT

OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by Bus Market

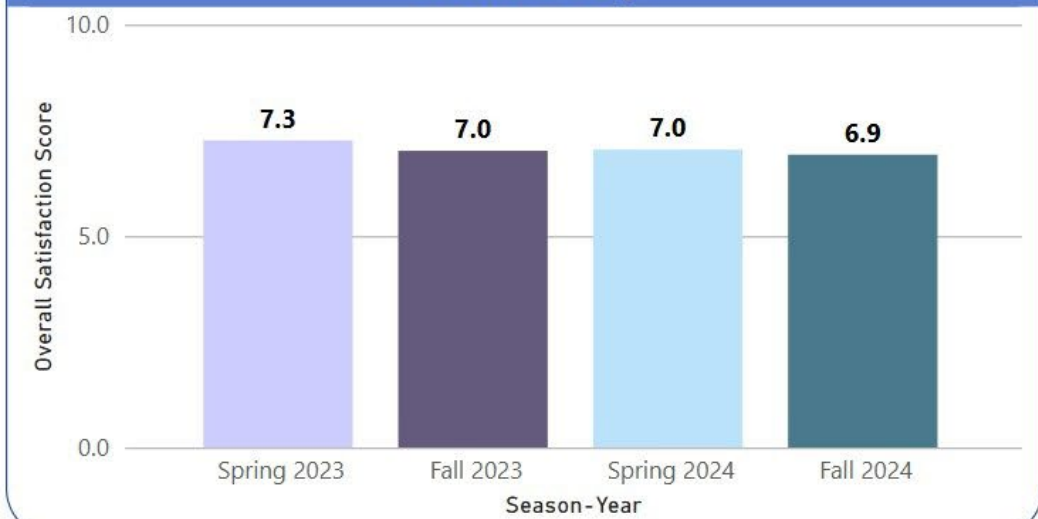
NY Interstate



North Jersey Local



South Jersey



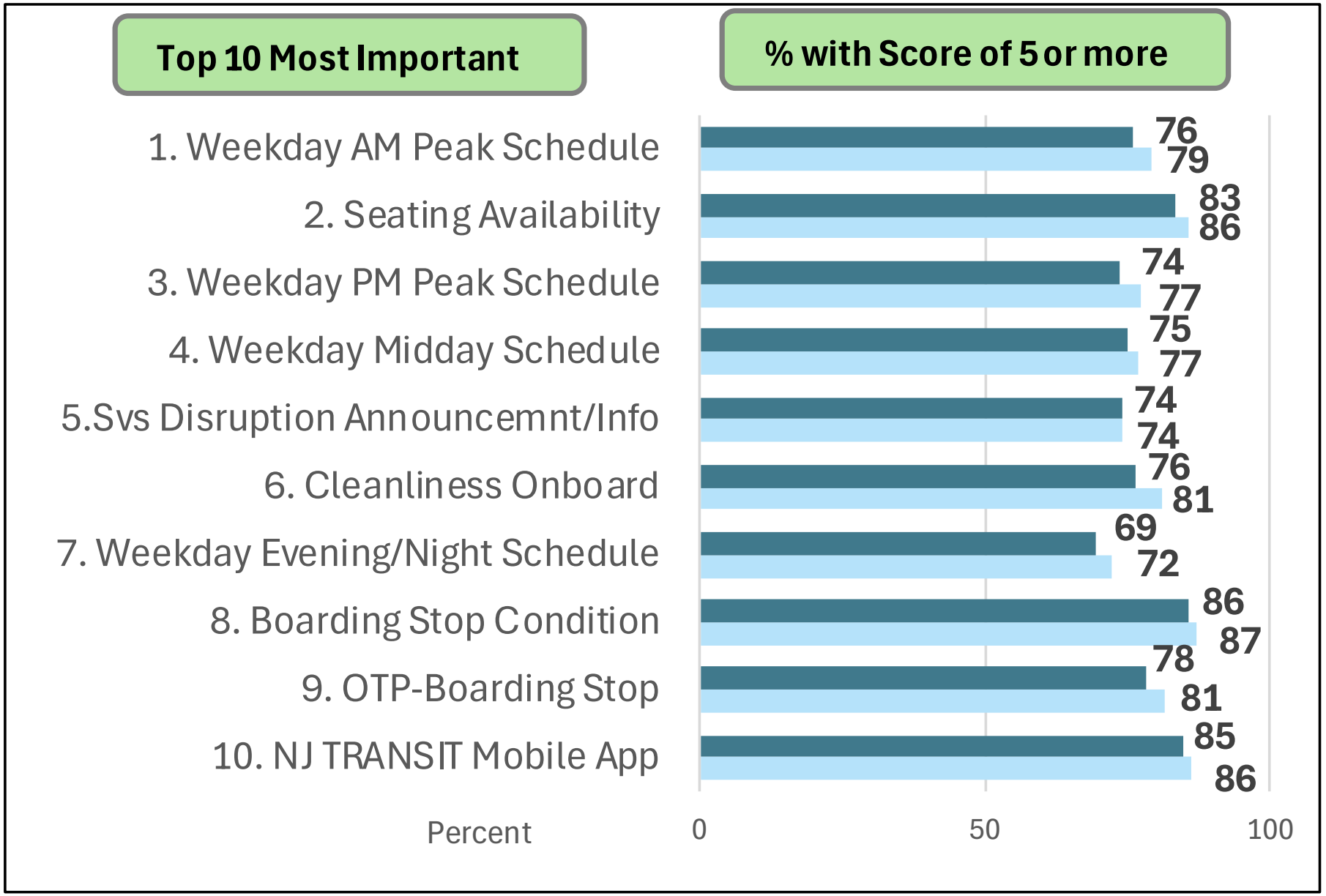
Contract Carriers



TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

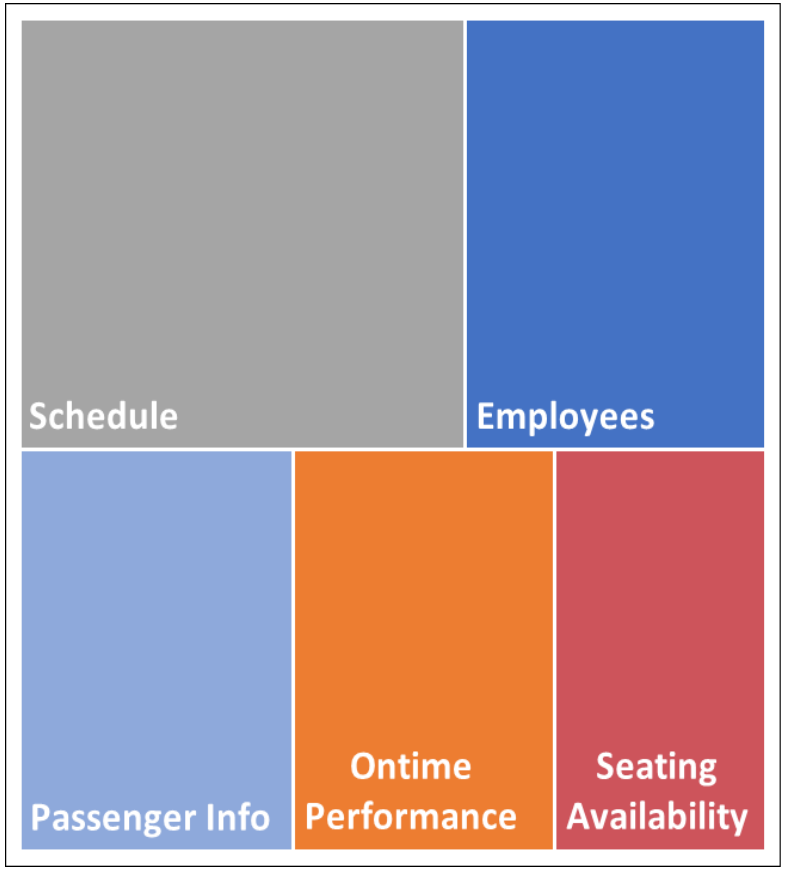


NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of BUS Comments

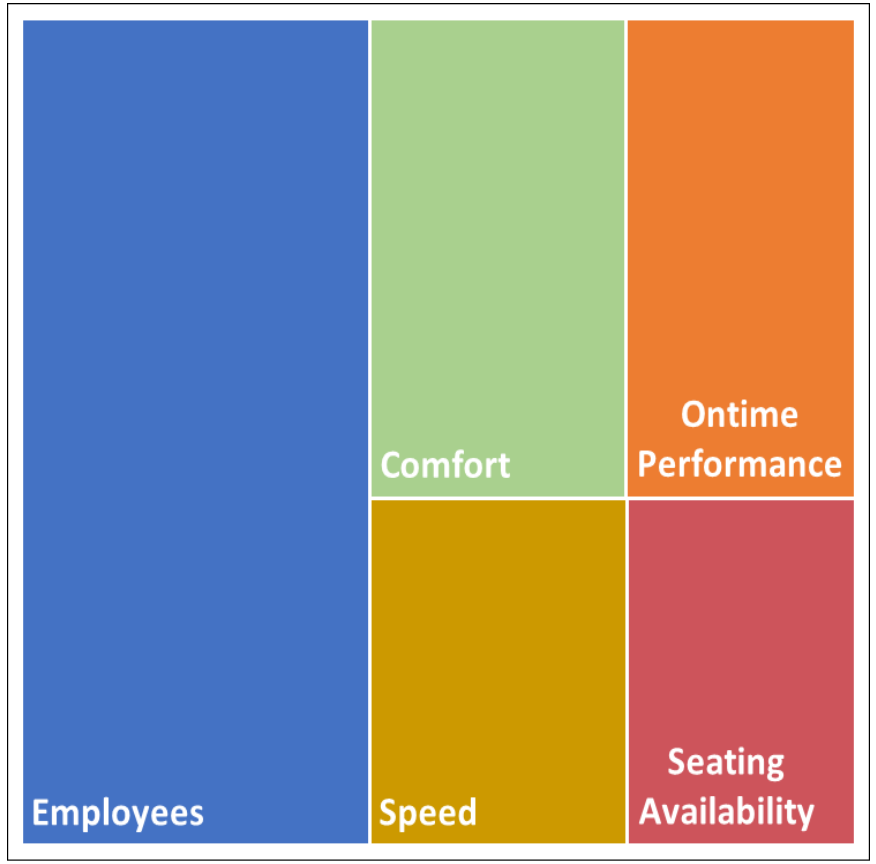
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



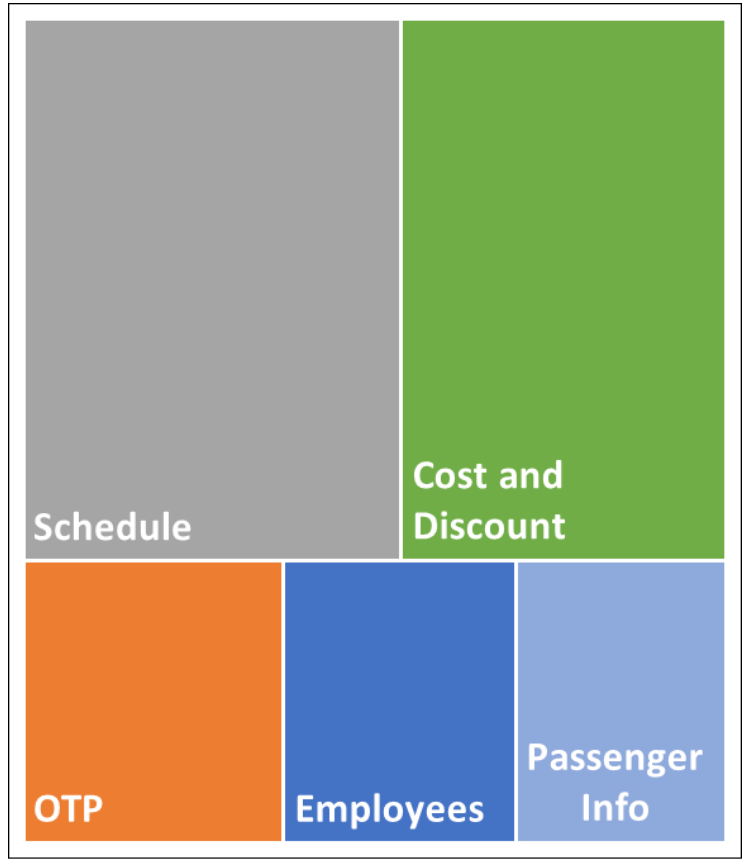
8,935 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



8,519 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



8,184 "Encourage" Comments

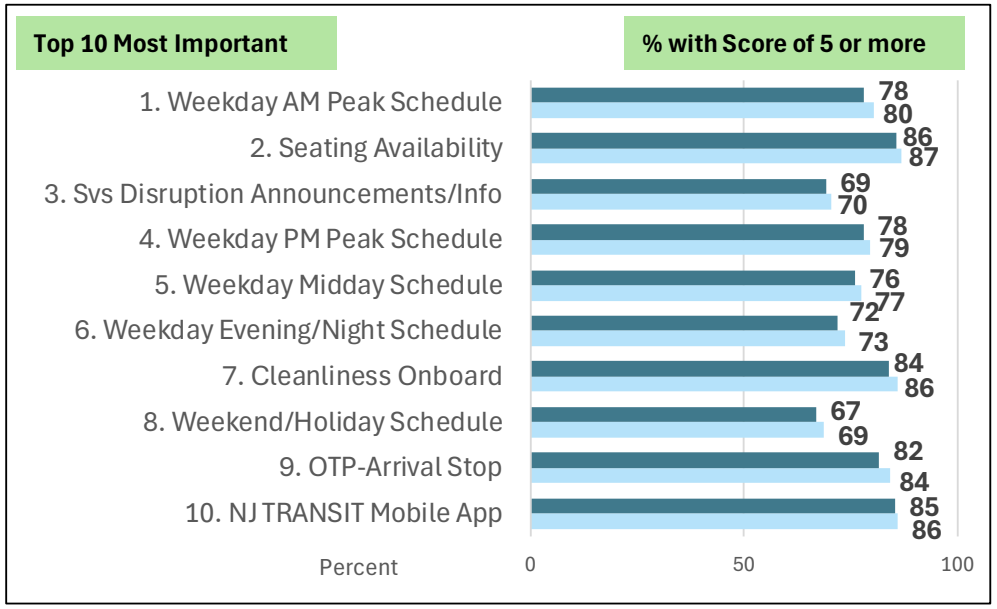
15,200 Bus Surveys

TRANSIT

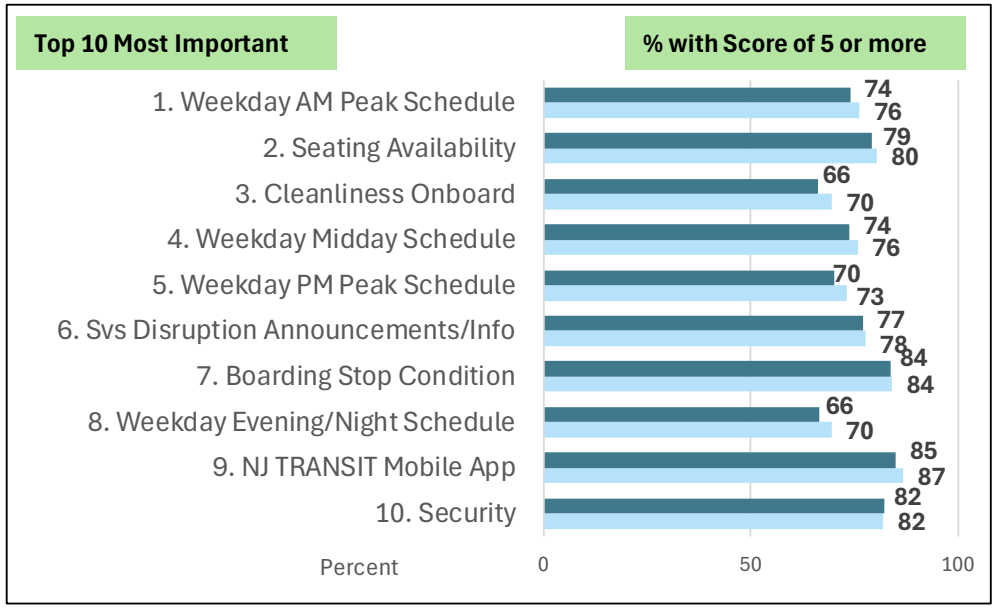
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers by Bus Market and Score

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

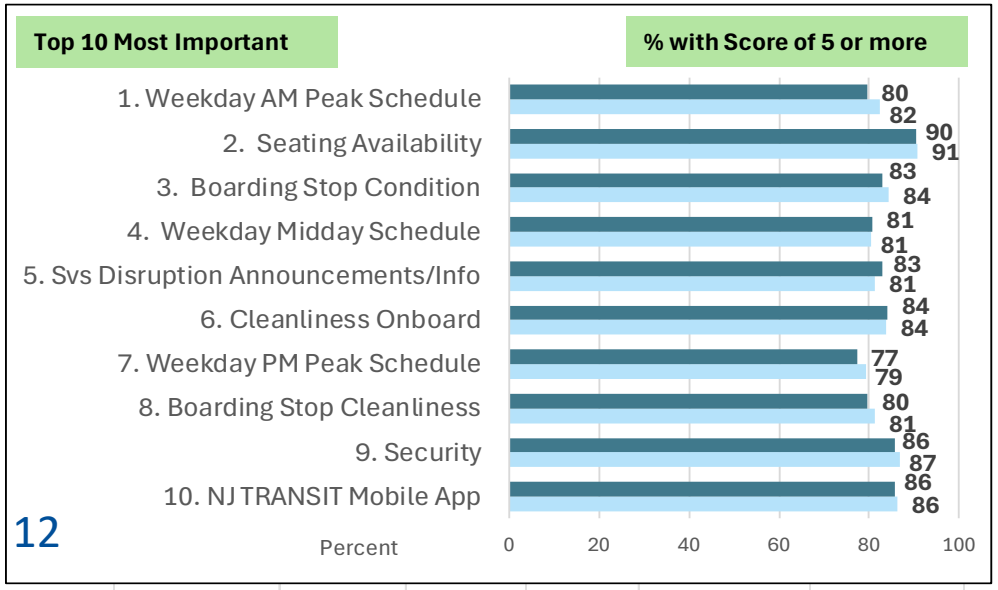
NY INTERSTATE



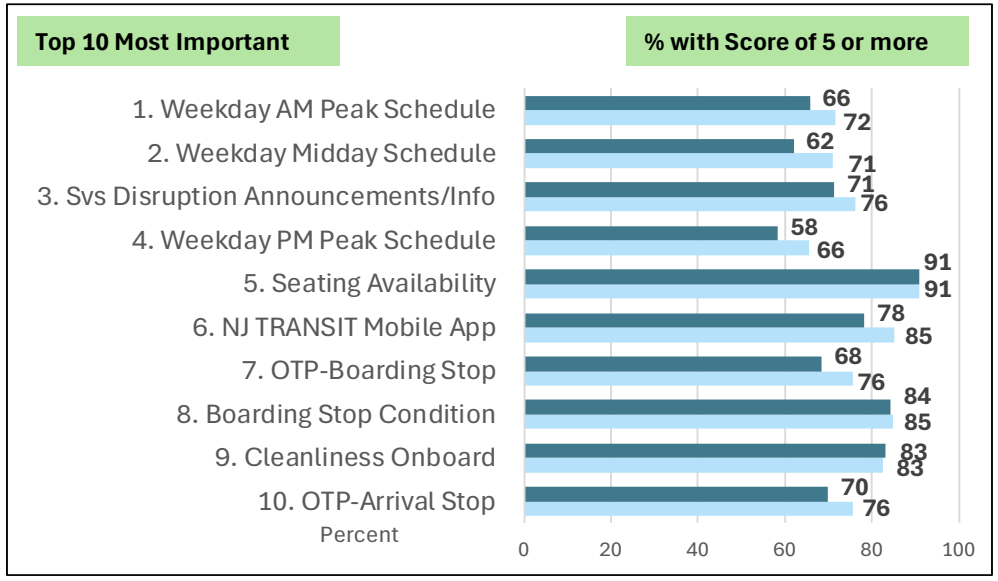
NORTH JERSEY LOCAL

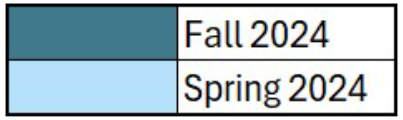


SOUTH JERSEY



CONTRACT CARRIERS





TRANSIT

Bus Score Context

NJ TRANSIT Assumption of Private Carrier Routes

The slight drop in Bus scores reflects some of the challenges NJ TRANSIT has faced as a result of the collapse of several private carrier routes in recent years and the direct impact this has had on bus service:

- From June 2022 to August 2024, NJ TRANSIT has absorbed or added service for 26 routes that were previously operated by private carriers (either under contract or directly operated) with almost no advance notice:
  - Nos. 10 and 119 previously operated by Coach USA
  - Four routes under the North Hudson contract
  - Emergency service for four discontinued DeCamp routes
  - Three abandoned Coach O.N.E. routes
  - Three abandoned A&C routes
  - Seven contracted Monmouth County routes
  - Three Contracted Hudson County Routes

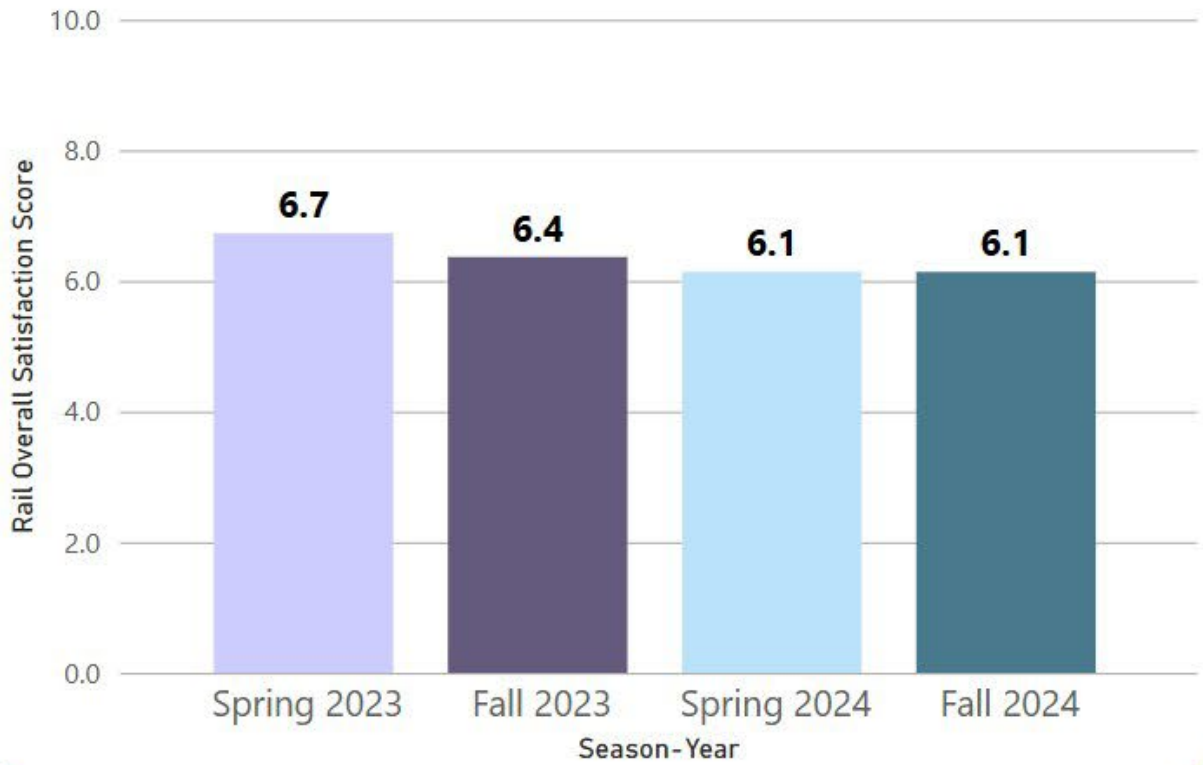
Bus Score Context

NJ TRANSIT Assumption of Private Carrier Routes (Continued)

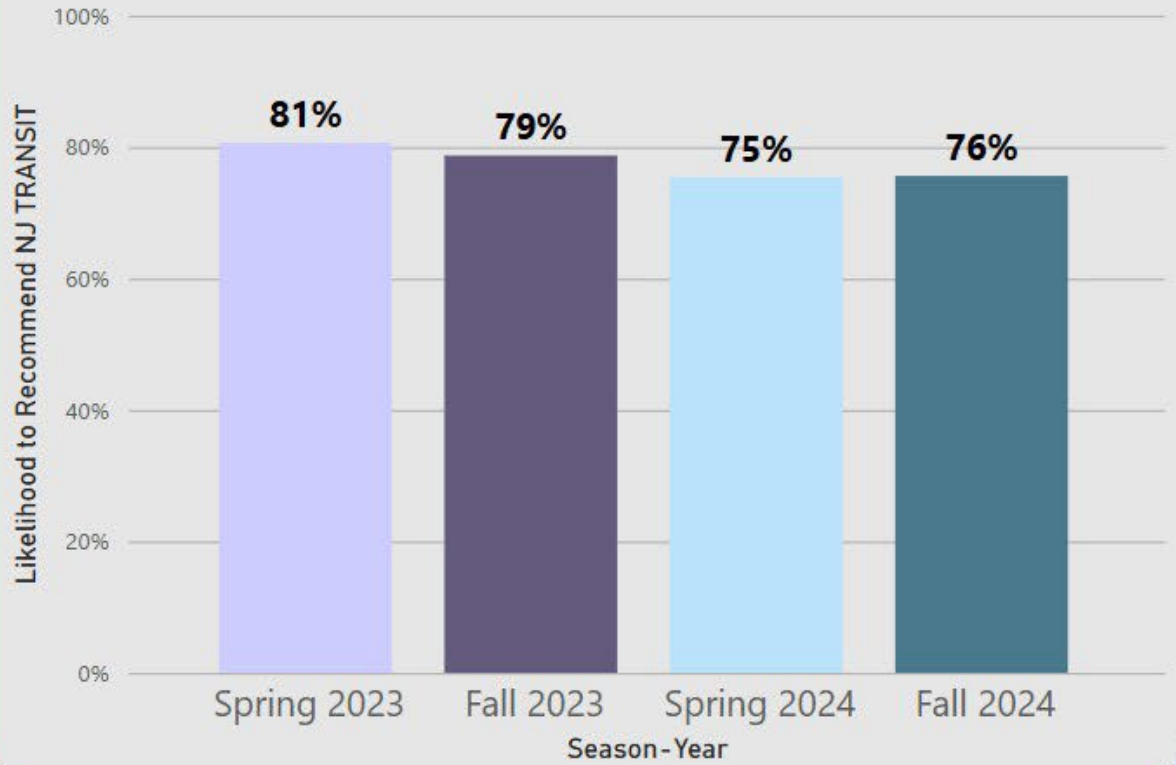
- 175 operators were required to cover these services and 1,099 weekday trips were added to the system, requiring Bus Operations to strategically adjust existing services
- Private carrier buses were brought back into the NJT fleet, which required upgrading them to NJT's level of technology
- Bus ridership jumped from 460,000 customers to 500,000 customers in September 2024
- Most of the absorbed private carrier services had to be increased over the last 18 months due to ridership demand
- Absorbing the private carrier routes has had a direct impact on NJT service delivery, as reflected in the survey scores
- However, the marginal declines in scores indicate that we successfully ensured no area was left without service options in the aftermath of the private carrier collapse

Rail System

Overall Satisfaction Score



Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT

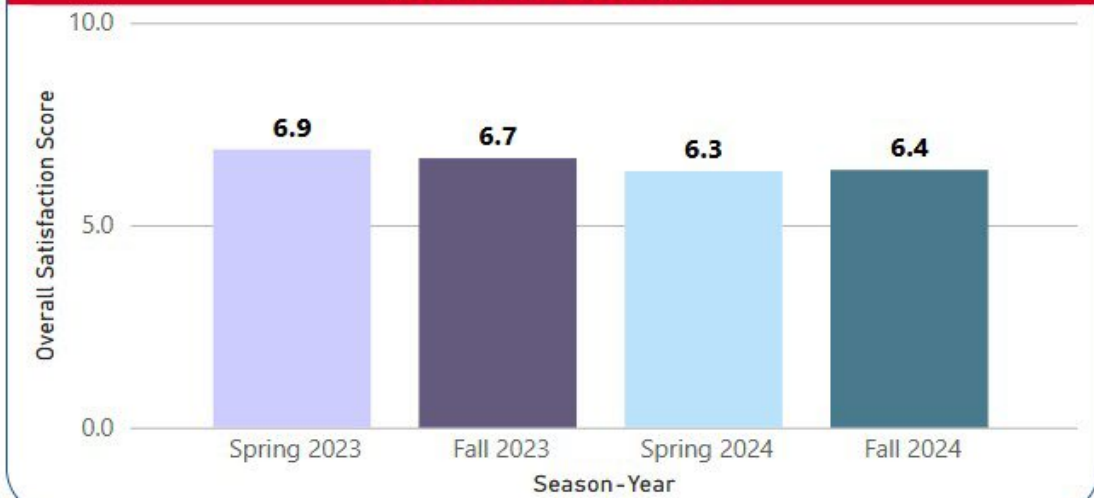


TRANSIT

OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by Rail Line

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

Northeast Corridor



North Jersey Coast



Raritan Valley



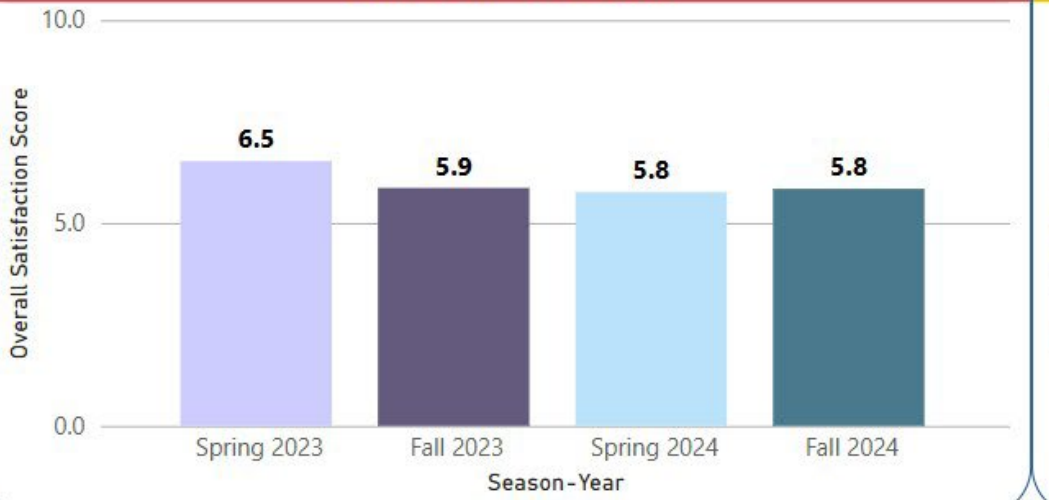
Morris & Essex



TRANSIT

OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by Rail Line

Montclair-Boonton



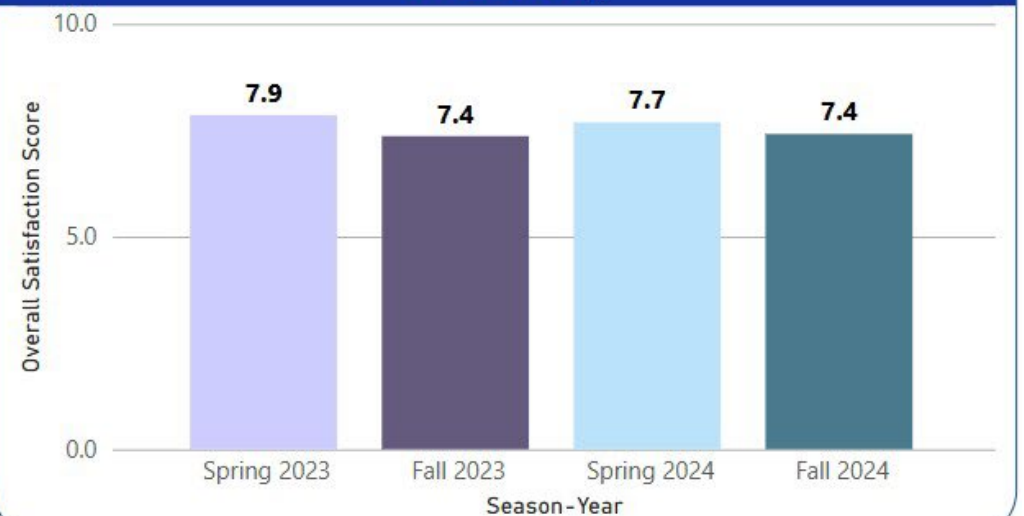
Main-Bergen County/Port Jervis



Pascack Valley

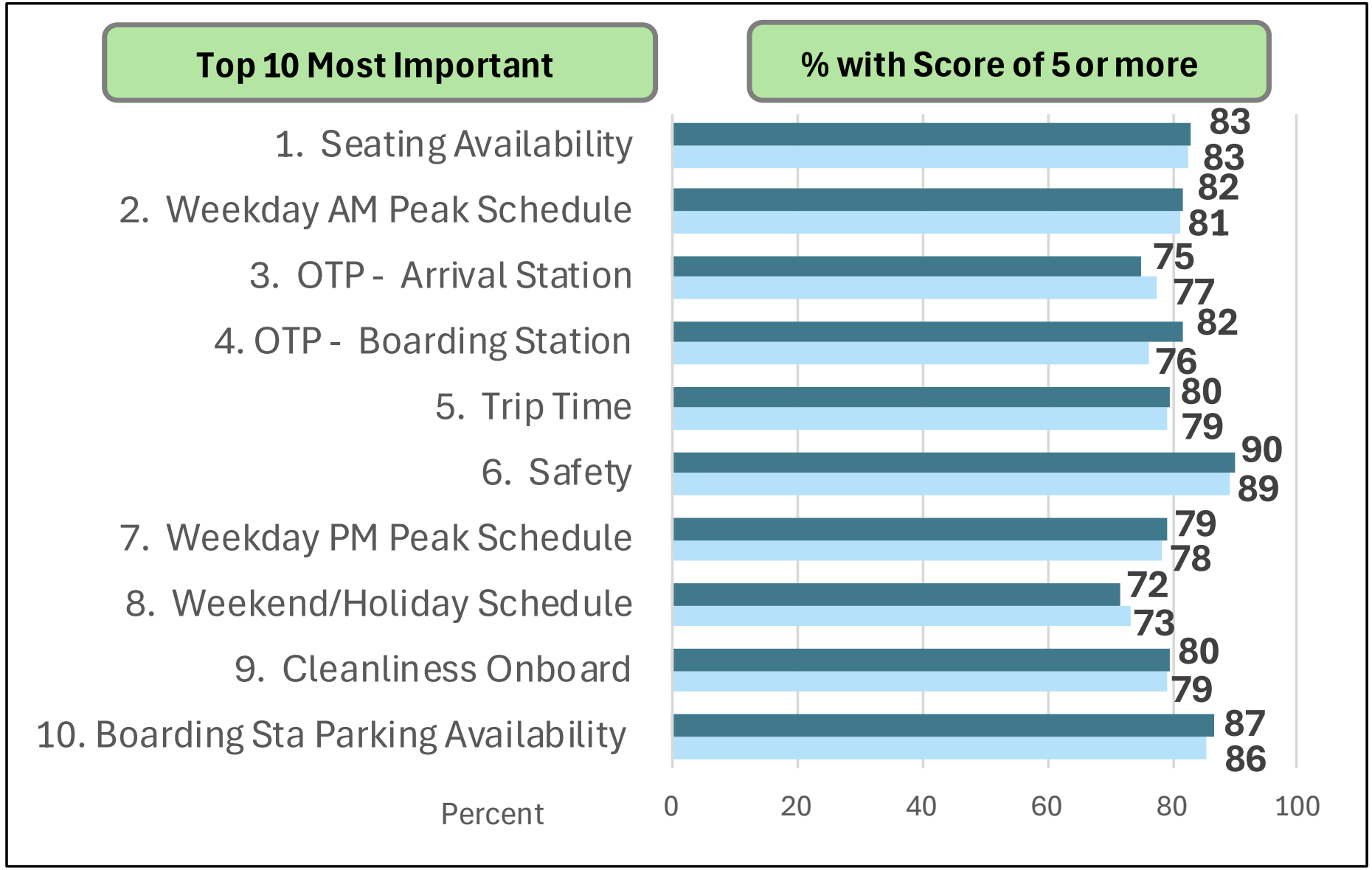


Atlantic City



TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL

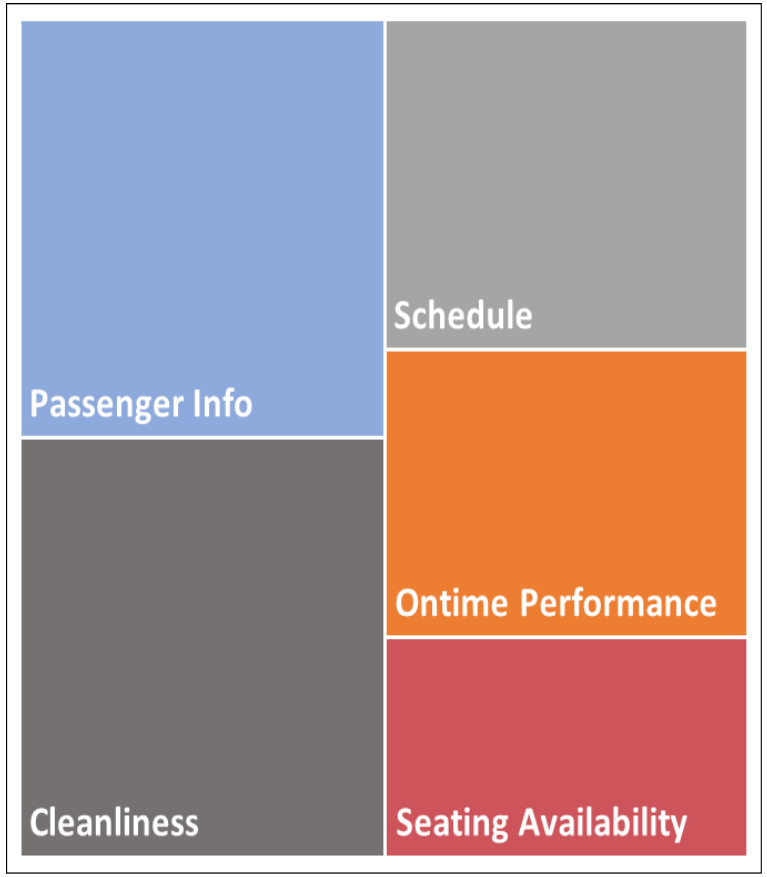


TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of RAIL Comments

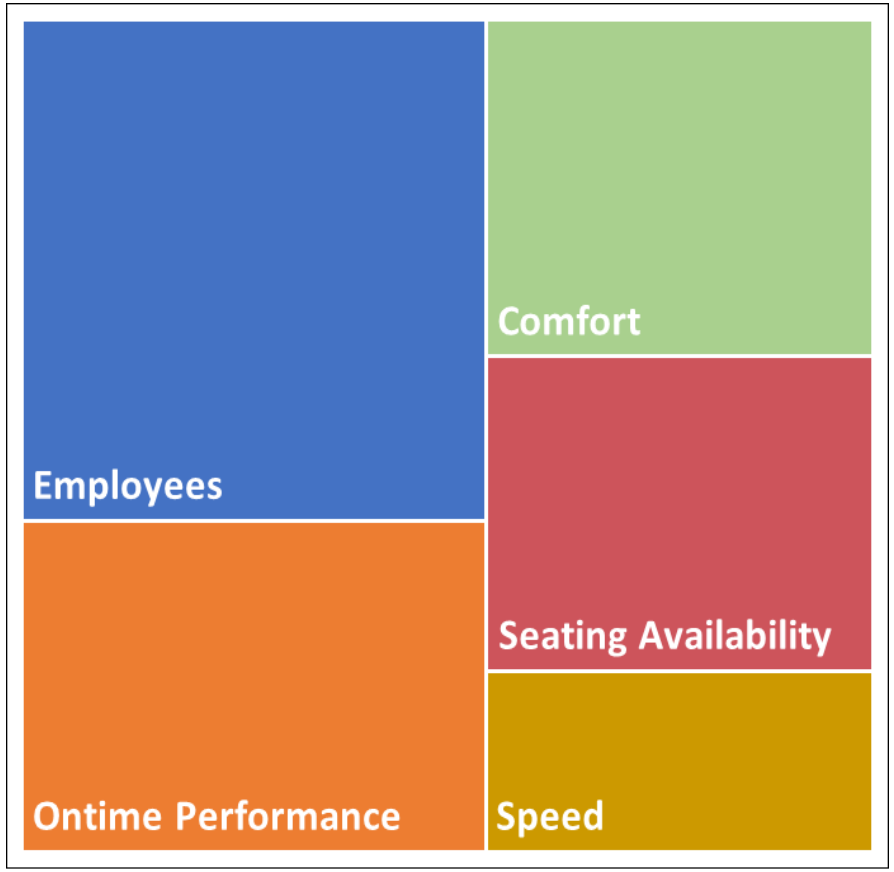
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



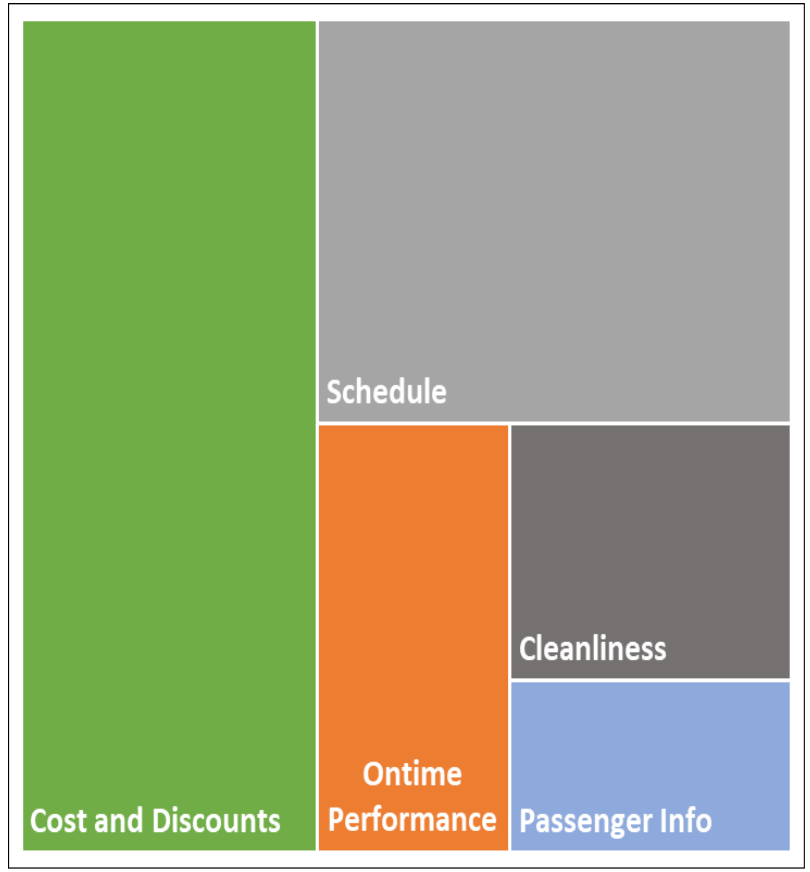
12,044 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



11,548 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



11,198 "Encourage" Comments

17,563 Rail Surveys

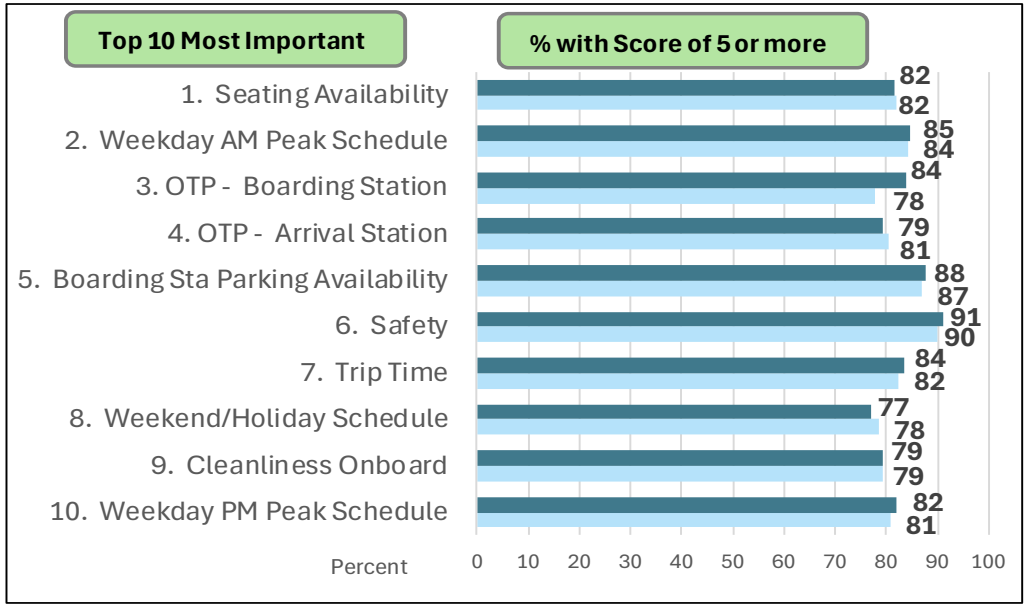
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

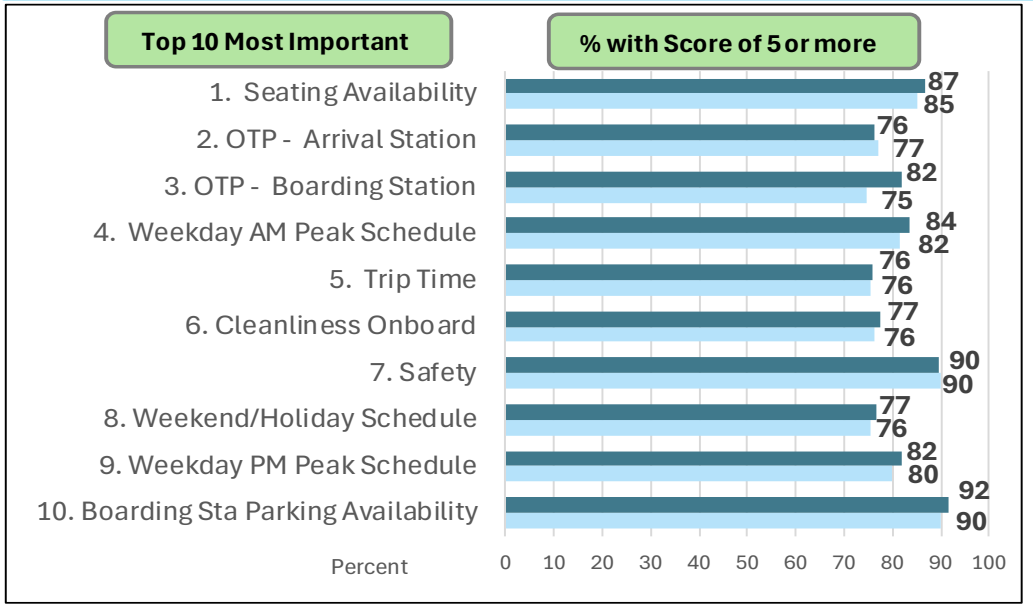
Customer Satisfaction Survey

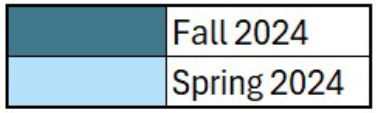
Fal 2024

NORTHEAST CORRIDOR

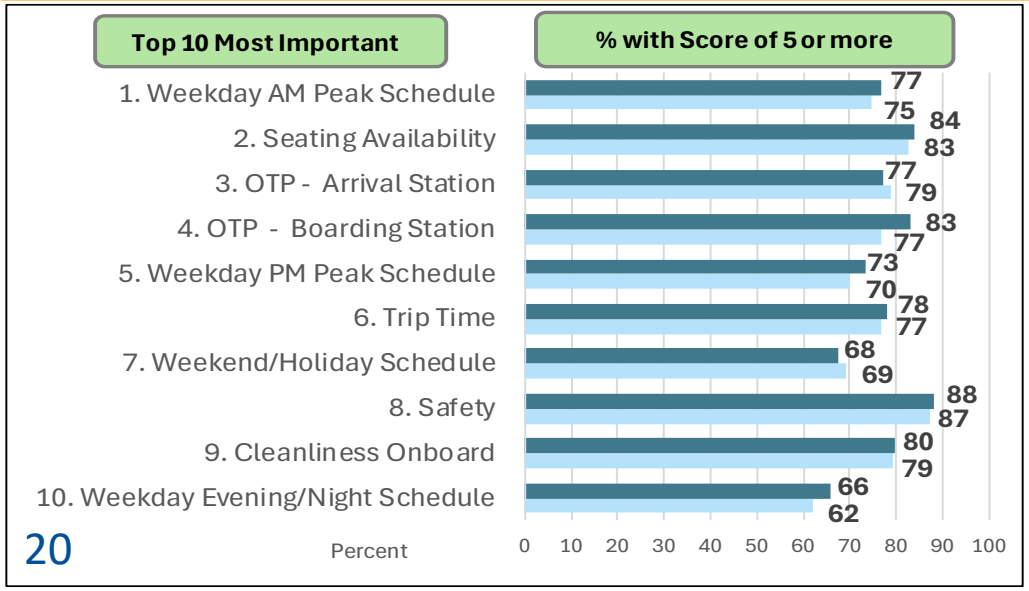


NORTH JERSEY COAST

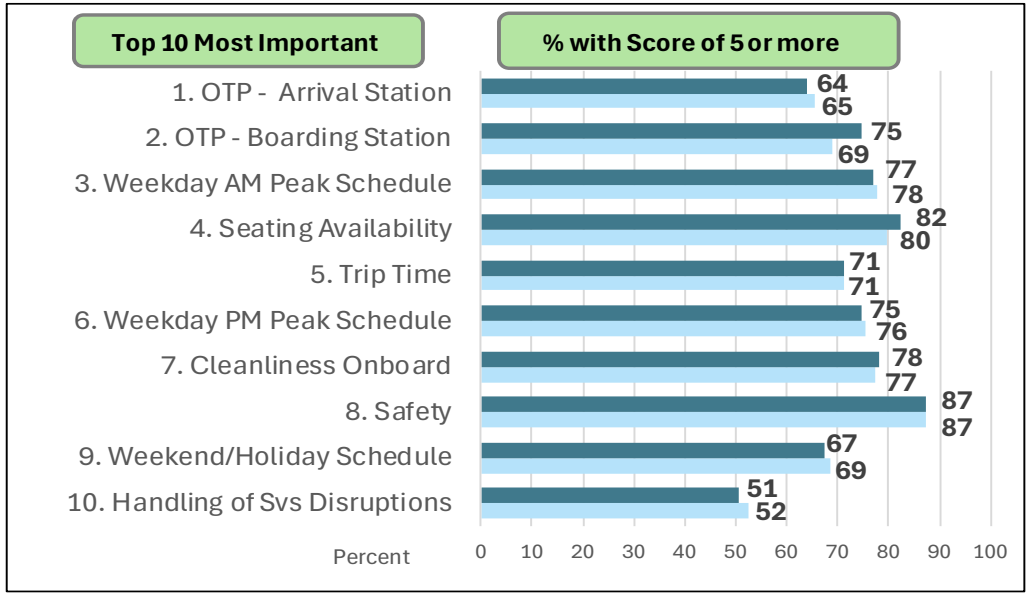




RARITAN VALLEY



MORRIS & ESSEX

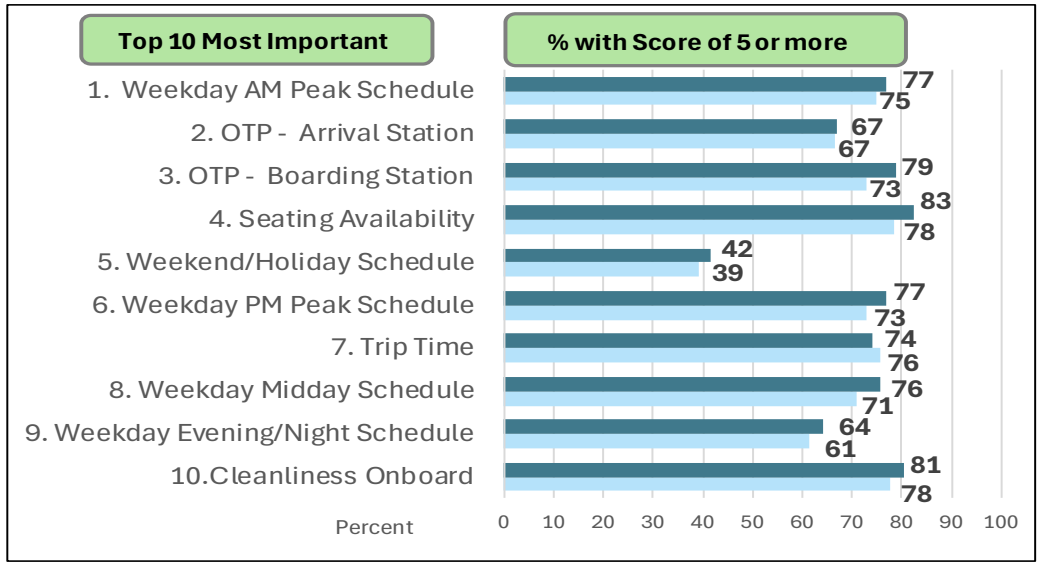


NJ TRANSIT

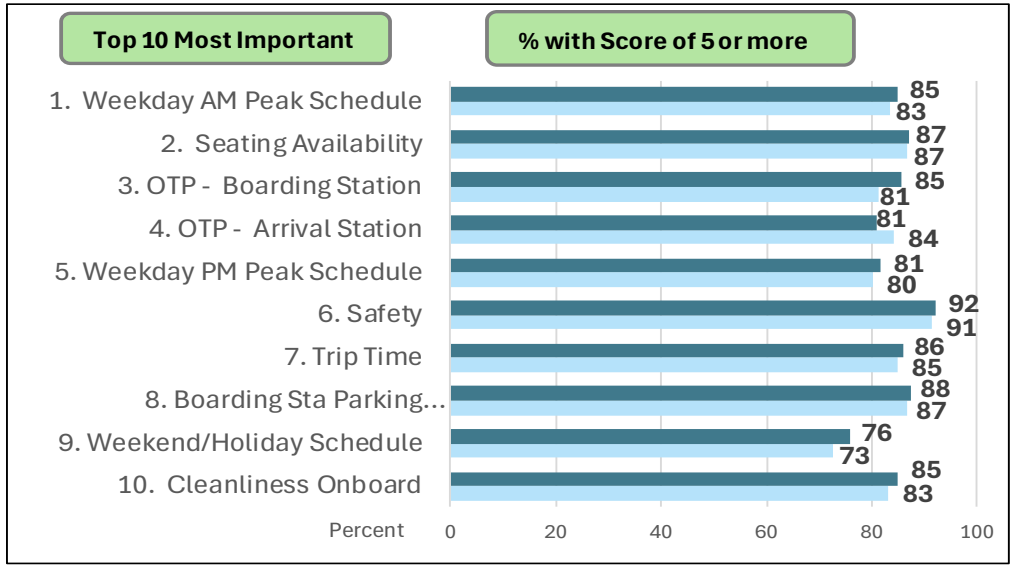
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

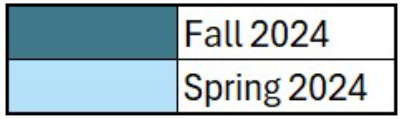
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

MONTCLAIR-BOONTON

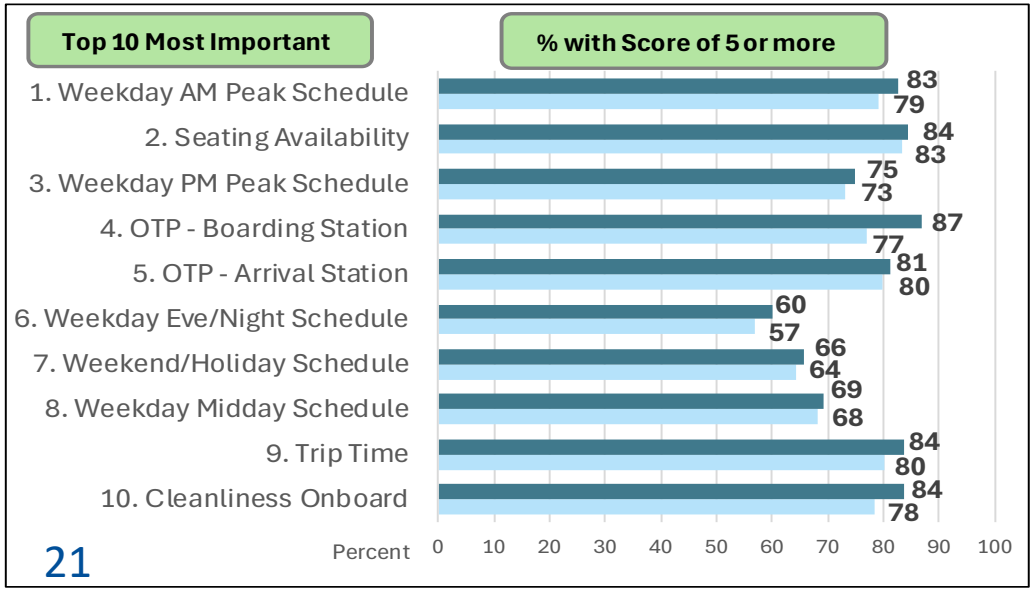


MAIN-BERGEN/PORT JERVIS

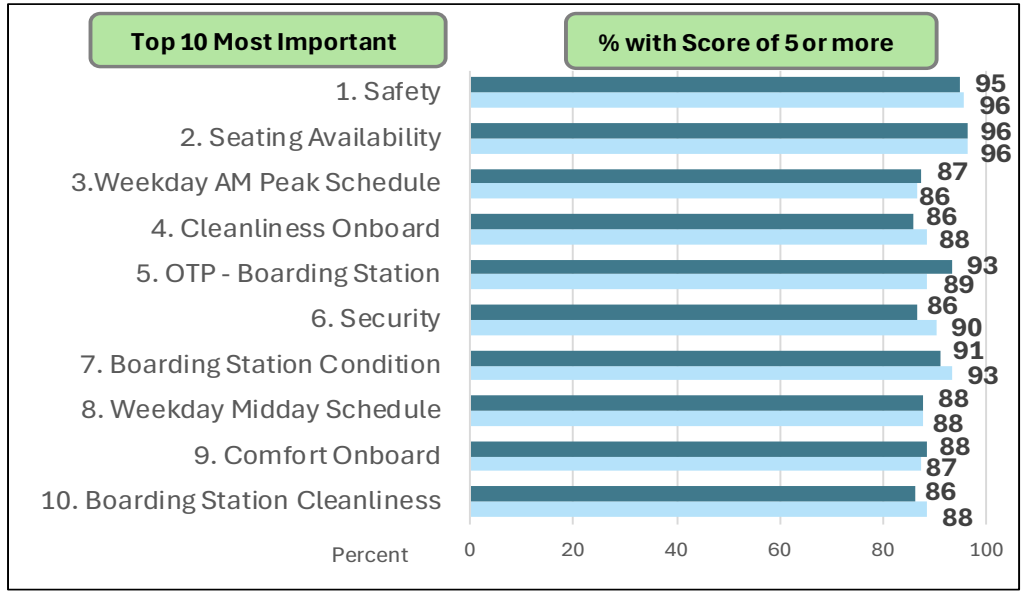




PASCACK VALLEY



ATLANTIC CITY RAIL LINE



NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

Service Planning

- Scores on most lines improved slightly, showing some recovery from service disruptions that occurred during spring and summer 2024 due to Amtrak power interruptions
- There was a schedule change that took effect during the survey period, with weekday adjustments on the NEC to coordinate with major infrastructure projects, and on the M&E to improve AM Peak spacing and frequency at stations east of Summit
- Ridership increased to highest post Covid levels in September-December period, about 80% of pre Covid ridership. Midweek is still highest ridership days, but there were also increases on Mondays and Fridays

Mechanical

- Window replacements update—we are 11 cars thus far (as of Monday 2/3) window replacement commenced
- Truck overhauls must be inspected and the group has begun ramping up for the truck overhauls

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

Infrastructure Engineering - Station Improvements

- Hoboken
  - Public Ladies' Room – full renovation
  - Public Men's Room – full renovation (starting spring 2025)
- Secaucus Junction
  - Track 2 Wall Replacement
  - Public Men's Room Fixture Replacement
  - Fire Suppression System Upgrades
- Hamilton
  - Platform Column Renovation and Re-coating
  - Eastbound platform stair stabilization
  - Overpass Terrazzo Repairs (starting Summer 2005)
  - Escalator 3 & 4 replacement – Capital Project advertised for bids
- New Brunswick
  - Track 4 Stair Replacement (construction Spring 2025)
  - Station Door Rehabilitation
  - Concrete platform repairs
- Metropark
  - Pedestrian Tunnel Drainage Improvements
  - Station exterior Drainage Improvements
  - Track 4 Stair stabilization
  - Track 1 Stair set repairs and stair tread replacements
  - Repainting of platform windscreens, stair enclosures
  - Station waiting rooms interiors and exteriors
  - Concrete platform repairs
- Metuchen
  - Platform Lighting Upgrade
  - Public Bathroom Renovation
- Newark Penn Station
  - Terrazzo floor honing and resealing
  - Lighting upgrades in vendor concourses
  - Waiting Rooms - Bench refinishing
  - Roof resealing
  - Chiller replacement facilitation

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

Infrastructure Engineering - Station Improvements (Continued)

- North Elizabeth
  - Westbound platform ramp stabilization
  - Westbound platform superstructure stabilization
  - Rub rail replacement
  - Lighting stabilization
  - Concrete platform repairs
- Princeton Junction
  - Railing stabilization
  - Lighting stabilization
- Rahway
  - Stairway 11 replacement
  - Concrete platform repairs
- Edison
  - Concrete platform repairs
- South Amboy
  - Door Replacements
- Trenton Transit Center
  - Rubrail replacement
  - Platform stabilization
  - Canopy roof patching
- Elberon
  - Concrete repairs
  - Platform tactile replacement
- Westwood
  - Fire Suppression system upgrade
- System-wide
  - Replacement as needed of PIDs, PID stands and garbage cans

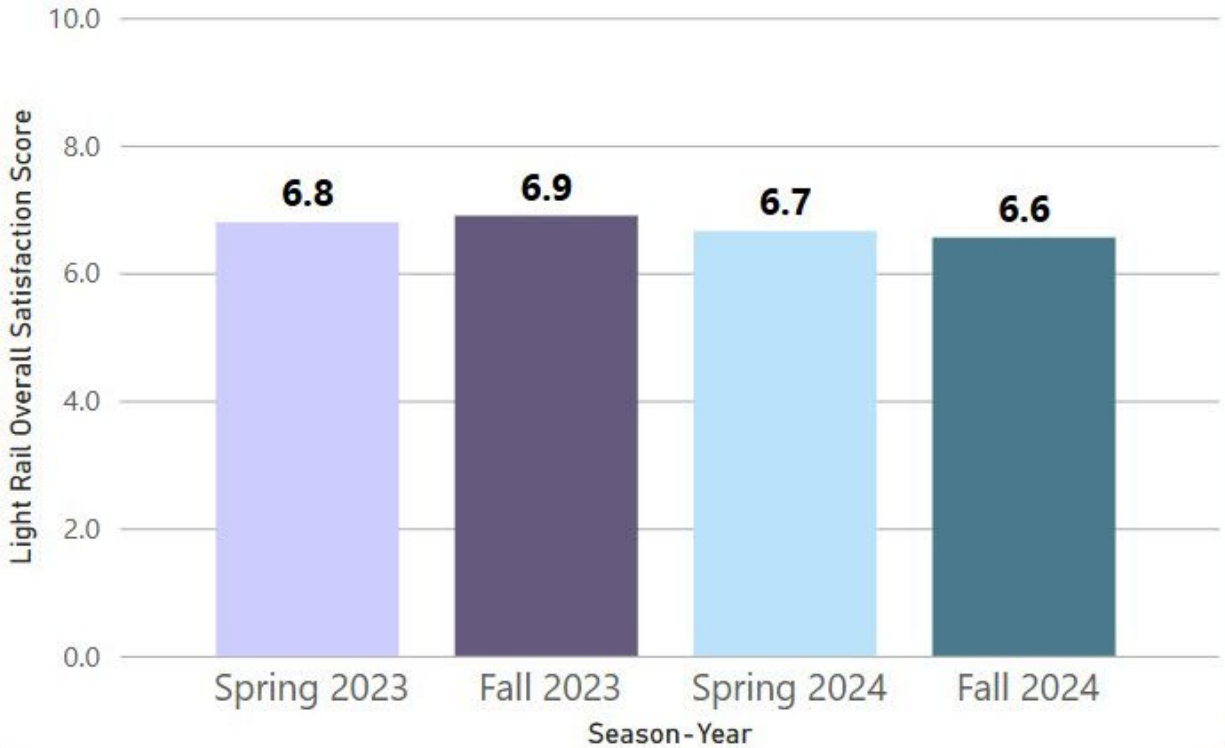
Vertical Transportation Improvements:

- Newark Penn Station
  - Floor replacements in Elevators 36, 37 and 39
  - Escalator upgrades of brakes and handrails on Escalators 9, 12, 13, 14 and 15
- Secaucus
  - Elevator PE 6 Upgrade
  - Escalator Brake Upgrades in Escalators 1, 2, 10, 16, 17, 19 & 20

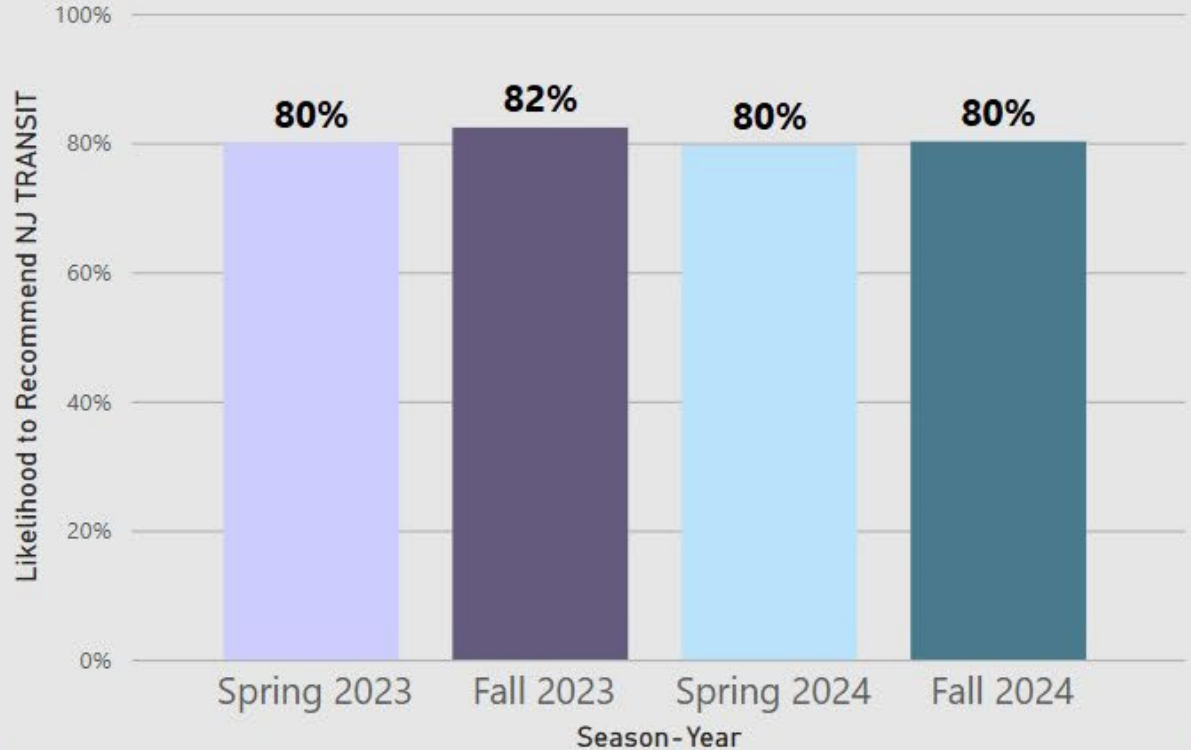
NJ TRANSIT

Light Rail System

Overall Satisfaction Score



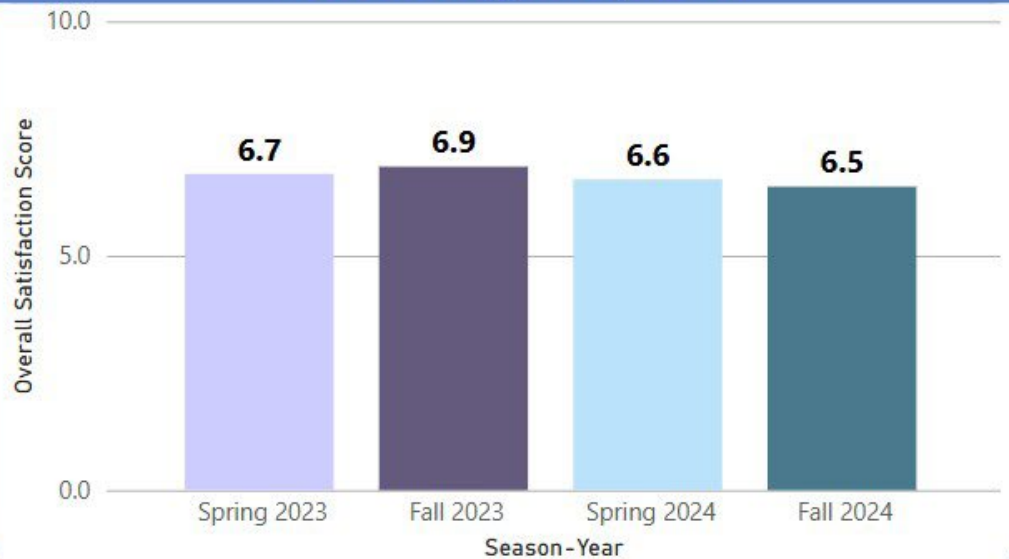
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



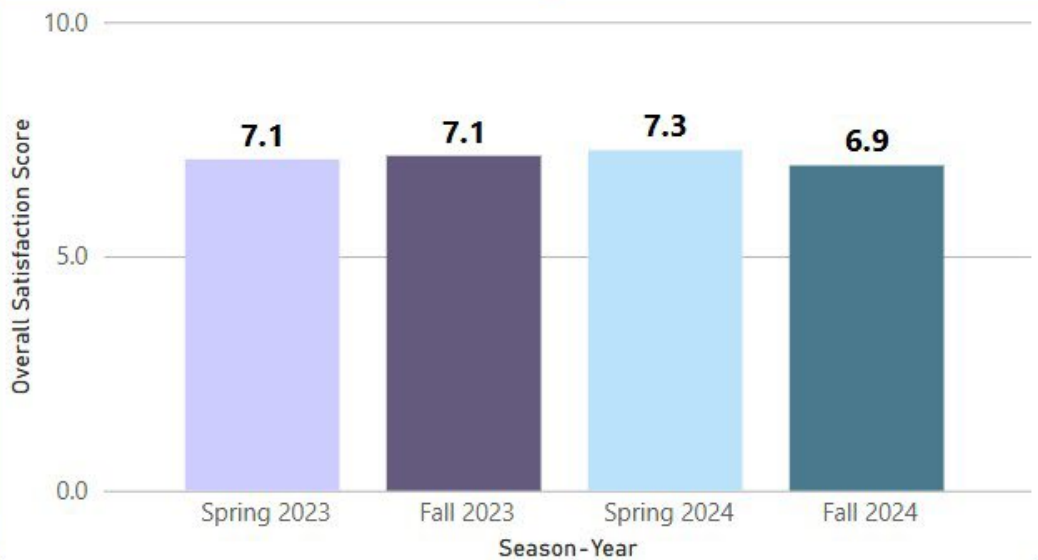
TRANSIT

OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by MARKET

Hudson-Bergen Light Rail



Newark Light Rail



River LINE

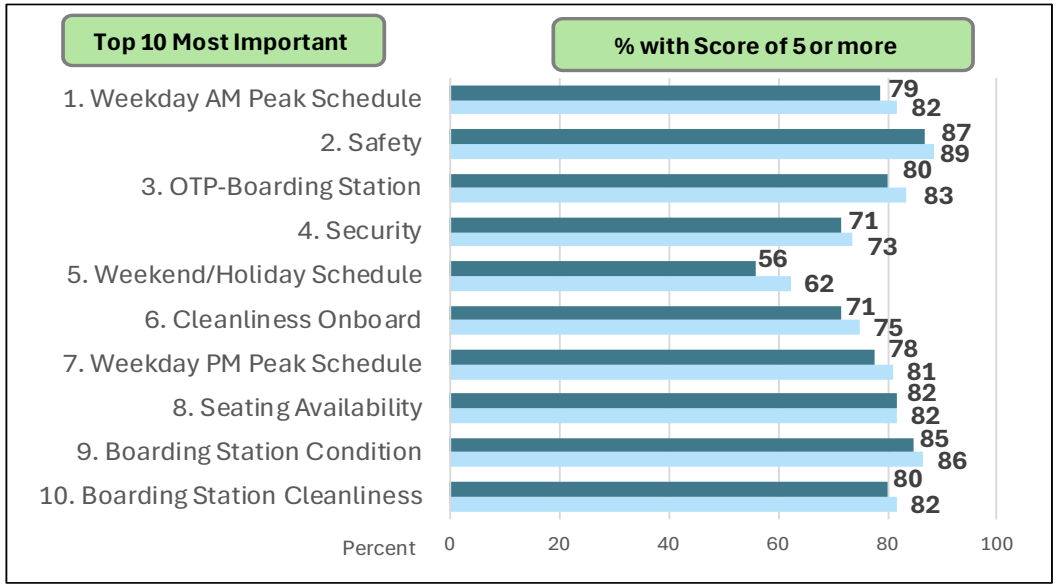


TRANSIT

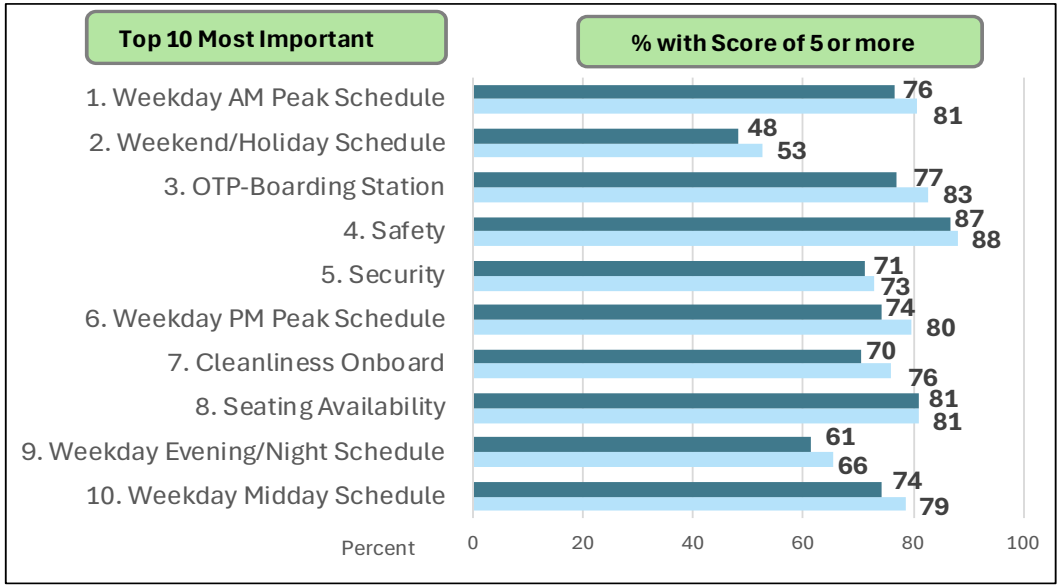
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for LIGHT RAIL Customers by Light Rail Line and Score

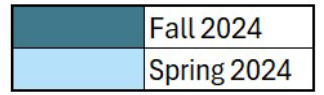
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

Light Rail System

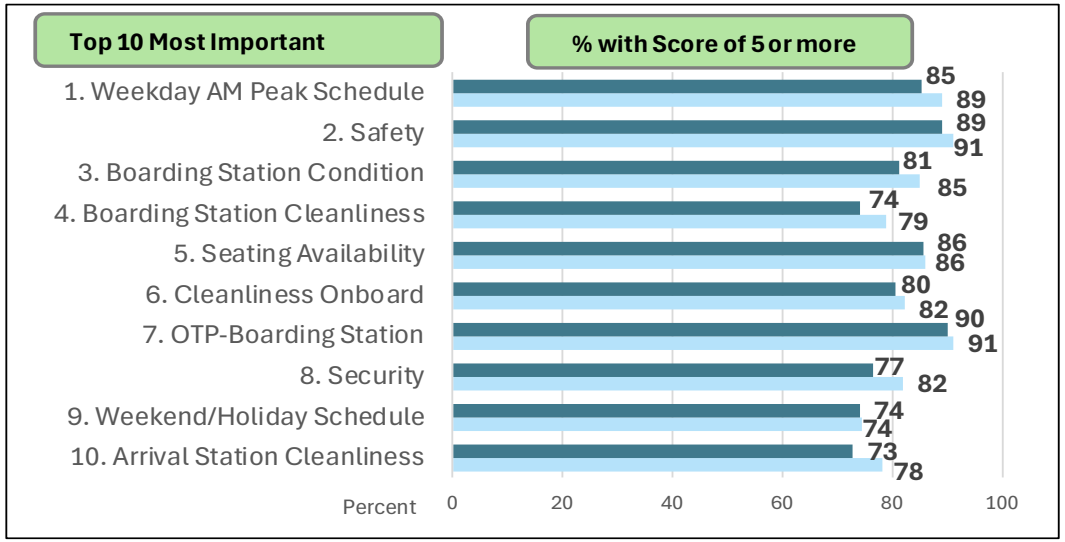


Hudson Bergen Light Rail

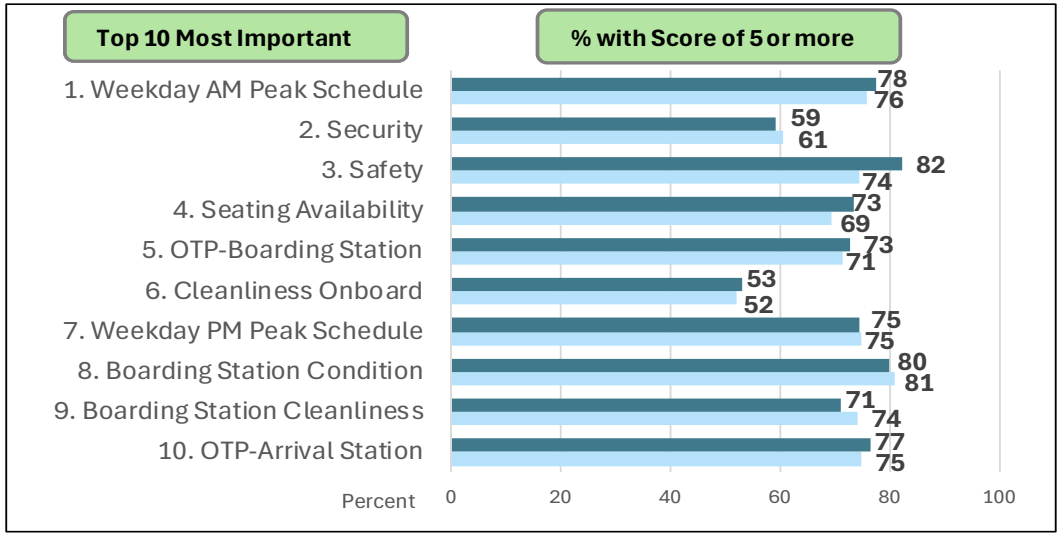




Newark Light Rail



River LINE

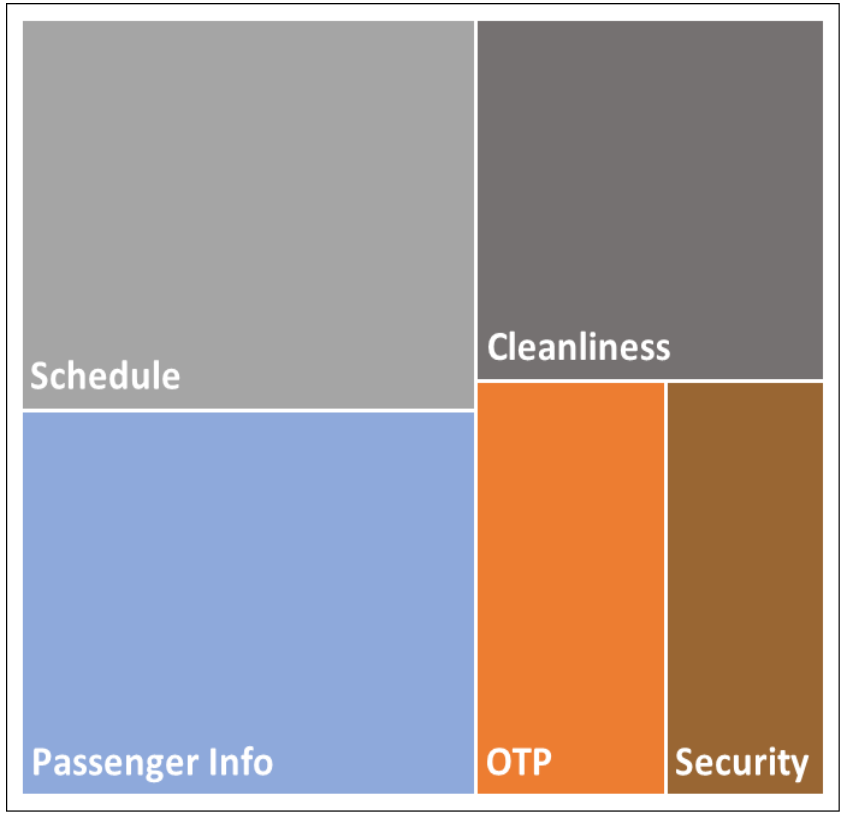


TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of LIGHT RAIL Comments

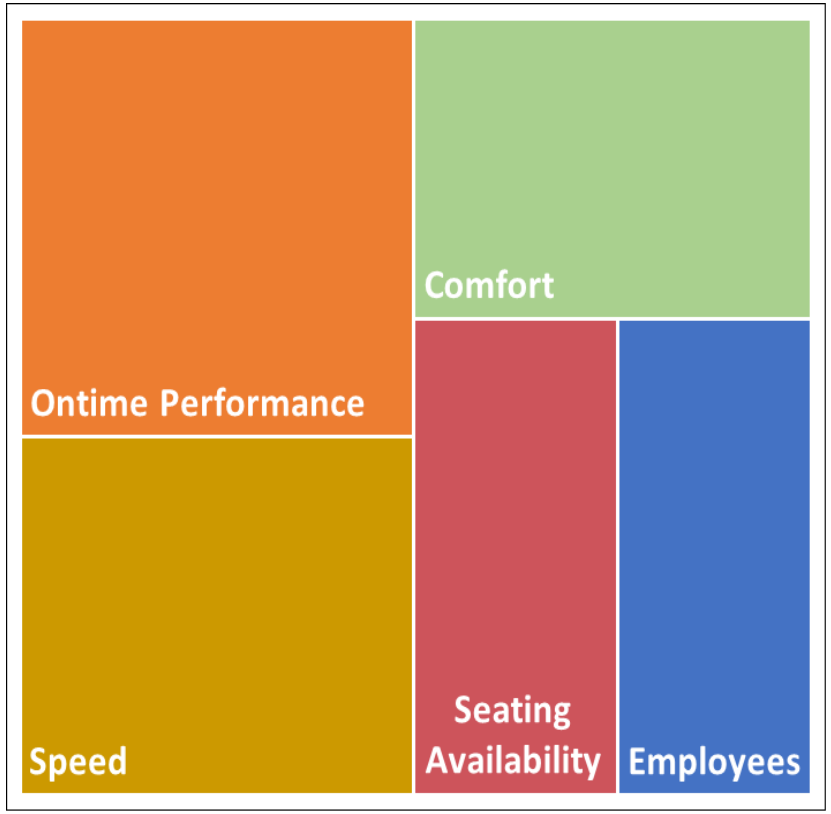
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



942 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



900 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



885 "Encourage" Comments

1,564 Light Rail Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

Hudson-Bergen Light Rail

- Scores among attributes related to Parking saw an uptick, thanks to coordinated efforts with the NJ TRANSIT Police Department to address illegal parking at stations
- Scores related to Facilities conditions decreased slightly, attributed to trash and graffiti at stations; Light Rail is doubling the cleaning cycles and inspections to ensure compliance and improve conditions
- Minor drops related to Scheduling and OTP are attributed to weekend schedule changes due to track work and state of good repair initiatives

TRANSIT

Light Rail Score Context

Newark Light Rail

- Scores related to Facilities decreased, primarily as the result of escalator outages at Newark Penn Station and a stairwell closure at Military Park on the inbound platform, which are scheduled for repair
- Scores for both Scheduling and OTP decreased, though on-time performance data improved from the prior survey period, from 98.4 to 99.1 percent
- Scores for Vehicle Interior Condition also decreased, attributed to trash left behind on vehicles; Light Rail is re-implementing the program of mid-run policing of trash on vehicles by increased cleaning crews

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

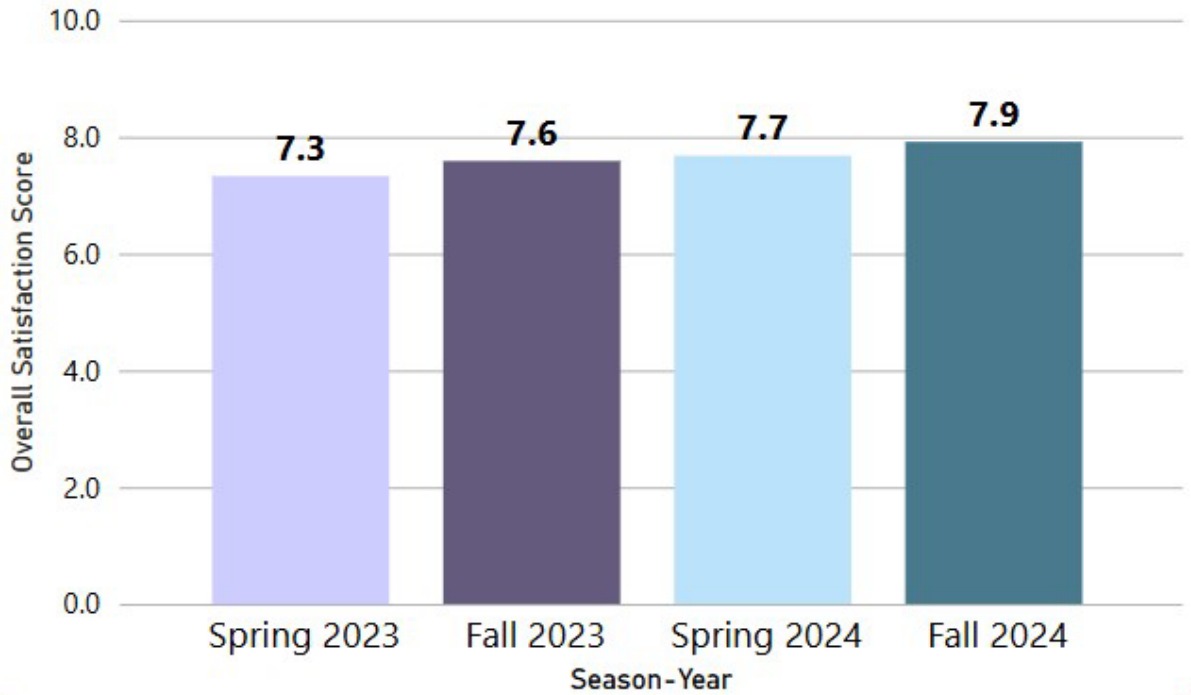
River Line

- The overall score for River Line remained the same, with positive improvements for some attributes, as a result of NJ TRANSIT's efforts to work with the contractor to improve service
- Weekday service satisfaction increased as the direct result of initiatives to improve service and maintenance; however, a minor decrease in weekend schedules can be attributed to some cancelled trains that occurred on weekends to enable us to improve peak weekday service reliability
- Onboard Vehicle Condition scores decreased, attributed to comments related to heat and air conditioning onboard, which are being addressed through the vehicle reliability program
- There was a significant increase in the "Handling of Service Disruptions" metric, which is an acknowledgement of our efforts made to address this very issue for customers over the past year, through direct interactions with personnel and customers during service disruptions, as well as post-service disruptions

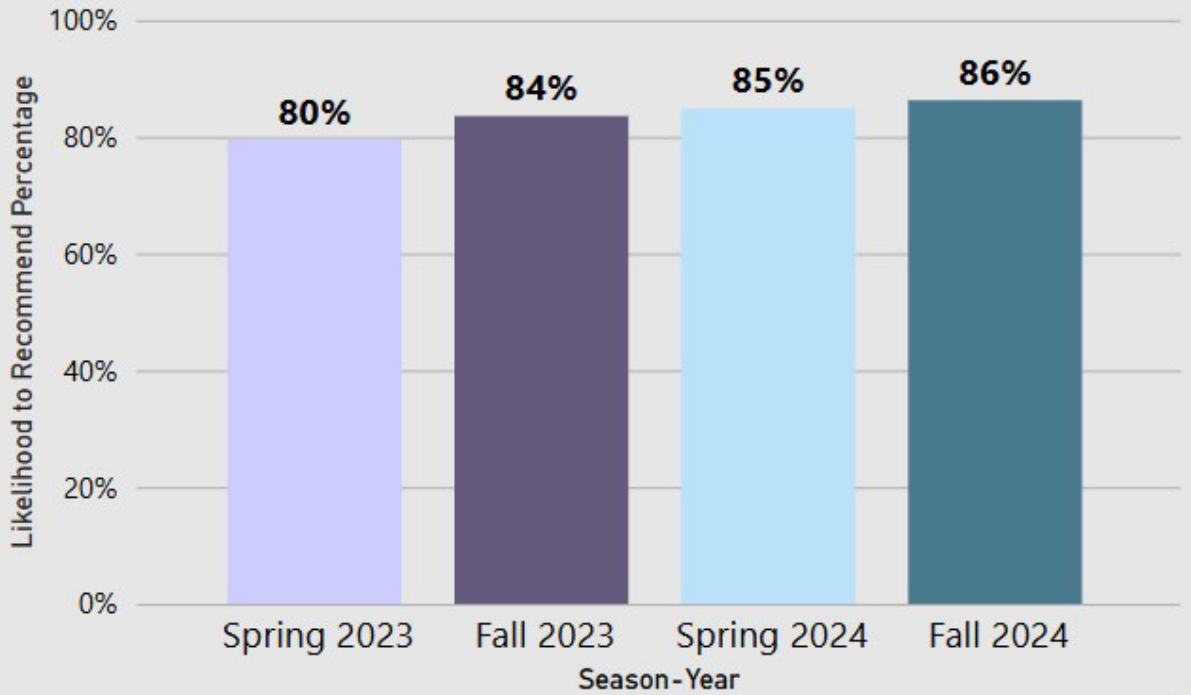
NJ TRANSIT

Access Link System

Overall Satisfaction Score



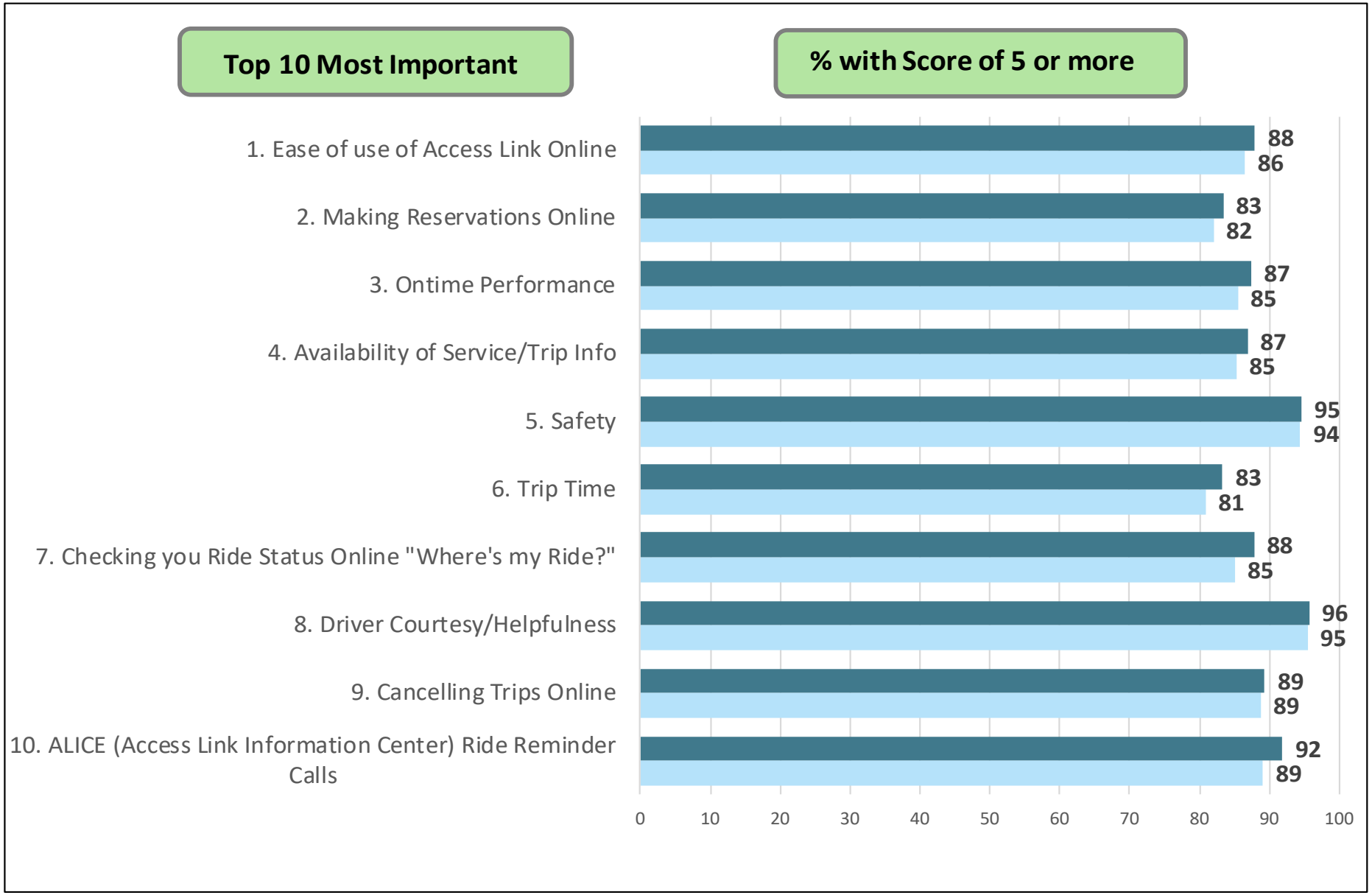
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for ACCESS LINK

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

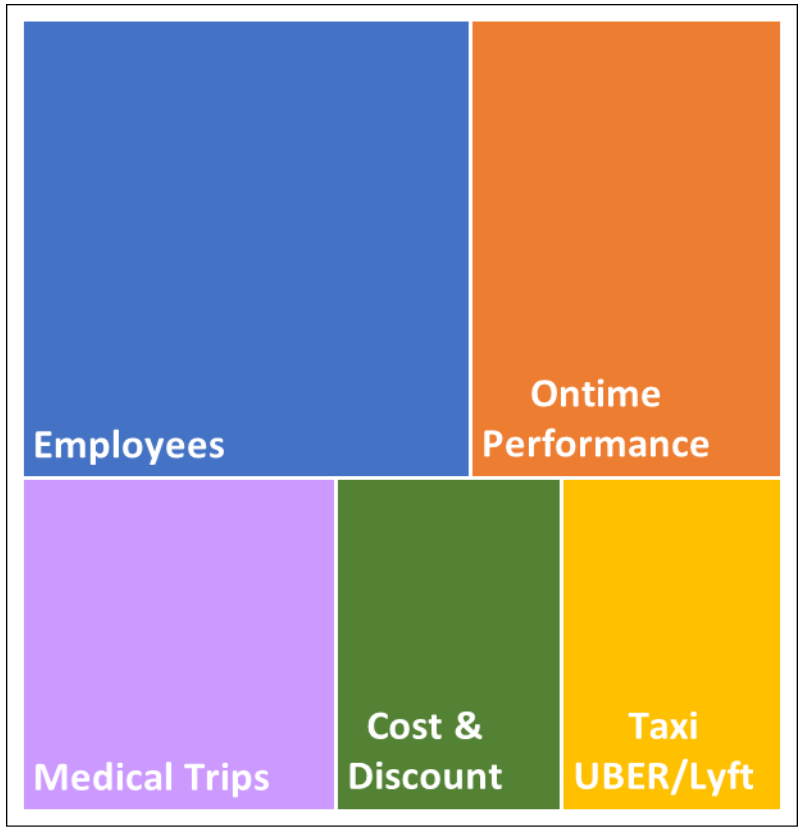


TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of Access Link Comments

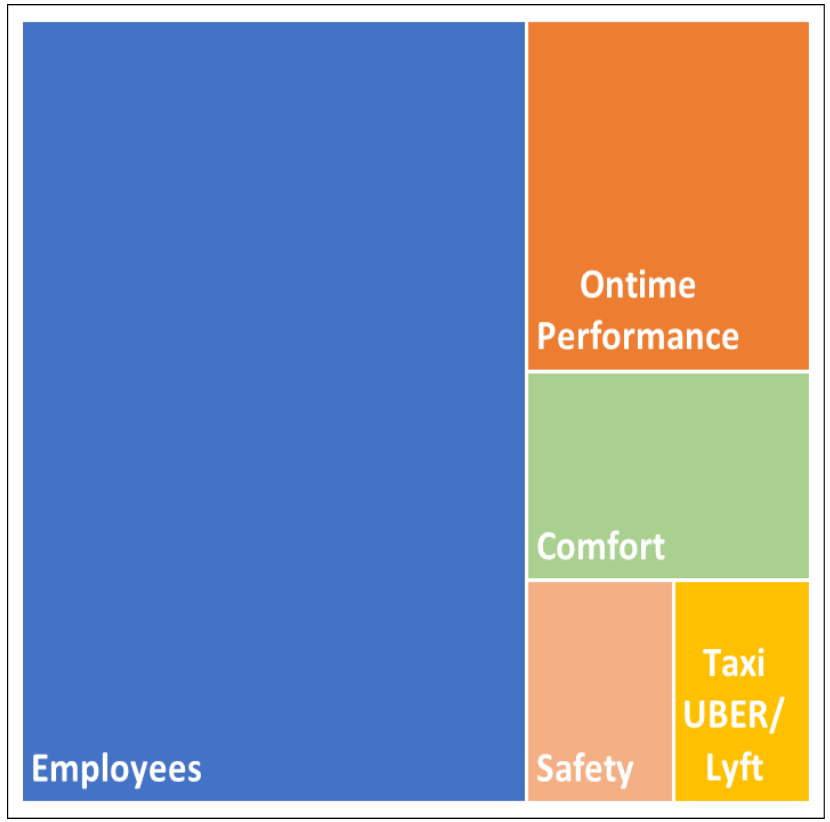
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2024

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



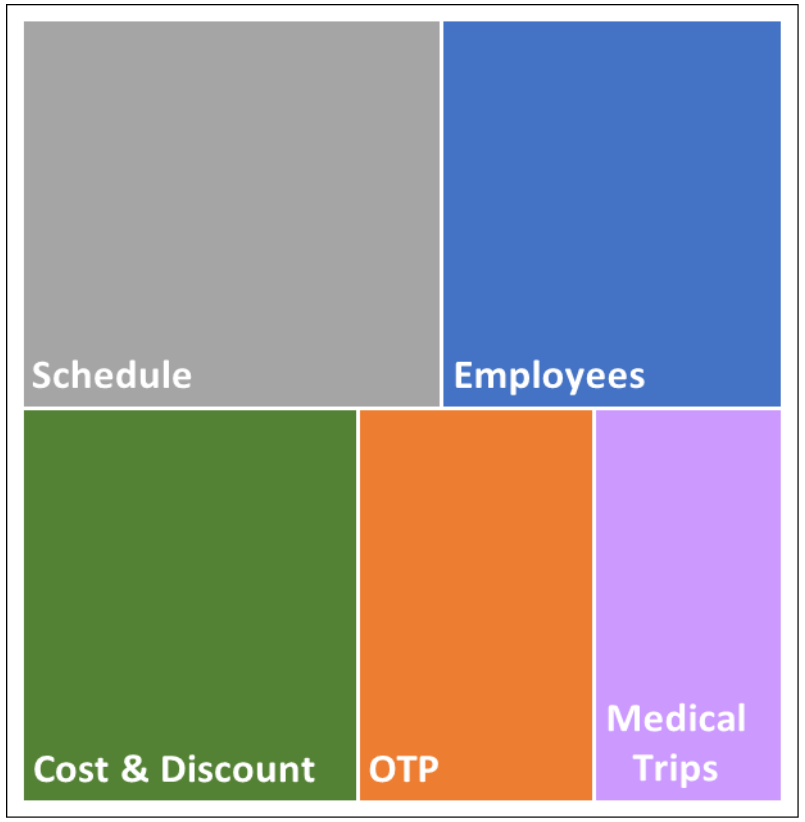
773 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



754 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



697 "Encourage" Comments

1,428 Access Link Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

Increased Access Link scores can be attributed to our consistent efforts to improve the overall customer experience, including trip times and on-time performance, option availability, and communications. Initiatives that have positively impacted customer satisfaction include:

Access Link Riders' Choice Pilot

- Access Link Riders' Choice Pilot 2.0 expanded to all regions and continued to be a useful tool in improving the overall service experience for 6,000 participants
- Also positively impacts customers who are not in the pilot, as it relieves pressure off the core service, allowing us to serve customers with fewer delays and positively impacting our telephone lines
- As of December 31, 2024, this pilot has delivered 447,144 TNC trips
- As we plan to revamp the pilot, we aim to maintain a high level of satisfaction related to customer experience and performance.
  - Via and Uzurv will be added to the pilot, both known for their top-notch customer service & performance

TRANSIT

Access Link Score Context

Interactive Voice Response Artificial Intelligence (IVR AI)

- The IVR self-service option has consistently been given high scores from our customers, now enabling customers to reserve more complex trips
- Virtual Agent is now available for extended hours
- Access Link telephone responsive staff take approximately 1.5 million calls annually
- This past year, the Virtual Agent handled nearly 574,000 calls, including:
  - More than 407,000 for Ride Status
  - Nearly 108,000 for Ride Cancellation
  - Nearly 59,000 Reservation calls
- Customers benefit from instant service with no hold times and 24/7 availability over the phone, while the enhanced system increases the availability of live agents to focus on more complex requests

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

On-Time Performance

- Increased satisfaction with Access Link on-time performance can be attributed in part to an increase in the number of vehicle operators:
  - Total number of operators increased by 25 percent (from 585 to 730) from Spring 2023 to the end of Fall 2024
- The addition of 254 new cutaway minibuses to the Access Link fleet to replace older, higher-milage models has also contributed to increased customer satisfaction
- Operations staffing levels have also increased:
  - Additional telephone-responsive staff and support have been onboarded, reducing wait times and improving our average speed of answer to ensure better support during Access Link peak hours

Outreach and Education

- Regular outreach and educational campaigns serve to increase awareness and understanding of Access Link policies and options
- Access Link staff recently increased the frequency of reminders and reference materials, with topics covering the importance of keeping personal information up to date, canceling rides in advance, and using all reservation tools, along with how-to instructional videos

TRANSIT



Summary

- 2024 Fall Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT Score is 6.5
- 80 percent of customers would recommend NJ TRANSIT
- The scores and customer comments have been shared with the operating groups and executive management
- Scores will be posted on the NJ TRANSIT website
- The next survey will be administered in the Spring of 2025

TRANSIT